漫漫之夜行迹
Trudge in the Long Night

目录 / Contents

挑战者 / The Challenger 2
玻璃瓶 / A Bottle 8
牡蛎壳儿 / An Oyster Shell 15
一次证明 / A Demonstration 23
童话书 / The Book for Children 31
有顶之屋 / A House, a Shelter 36
有顶之屋 / A House, a Shelter 39
小石粒 / Pebbles 43
三一律 / Classical Unities 44
海面以下 / Underneath the Sea Level 47
海面以下 / Underneath the Sea Level 49
穷举法 / Method of Exhaustion 51

挑战者
The Challenger COL-307901

The Challenger
挑战者

210: "A voice came from above and spoke to the man, 'An important thing will happen to you.'"
210: “天上的声音如是说，有件大事将要发生在你身上。”

The lecturer is young and proud, standing like a newly sprouted grapevine growing upright.
高谈阔论者尚且稚嫩年轻，他像是一枝新生的葡萄藤，挺拔向上。

210: "What will it be? The man asked."
210: “那人便开口问了，那是什么样的事?”

210: "You will gain wealth, you will gain fame. You will walk in the garden of wisdom and happiness. The voice answered."
210: “天上的声音回答，你将变得富足美满，拥有智慧与声名，迎娶美丽的妻子。”

210: "Thus, until he died, he spent his life waiting for his fortune, and it never arrived."
210: “于是，他终其一生地等待一个奇迹，直至死亡到来，一切仍未发生。”

The lecturer walks from one side of the square to the other, an unfurled scroll in his hands.
他手中持着记载文字的书卷，由广场的这一侧，步行向那一侧。

210: The voice from above brought promises—a glimpse of his forthcoming fate.
210: 天上的声音带来许诺，换而言之，那人窥见了自己将要来的命运。

210: He believed in the promise, and, in doing so, forged his own tragic end.
210: 那人便相信了，顺从，由此盲目，从而铸成了自己可悲的结局。

Thirty-seven: ...
37: ……

A soft, contented cooing comes from the audience.
这是平缓的、安宁的呼吸声。

Thirty-seven: ... Mhmm ...
37: ……呼。

Sophia: 37 ... 37 ...
苏菲亚: 37……37……

The whisper fails to awaken the sleeping girl.
低声的呼唤难以叫醒沉睡的姑娘。

After hesitating for a moment, Sophia reaches out and gently shakes 37.
踟蹰片刻，苏菲亚伸出手，轻而缓地晃动了两下身旁的 37。

Thirty-seven: ... Hmm ... Huh? What's happening ... ?
37: ……嗯……嗯？怎么了……?

37 rubs her eyes, lifts her disheveled hair, and looks around in a daze.
小姑娘揉着眼睛，将散乱的头发撩起，有些恍惚地四下查看。

Thirty-seven: ... Has 210 finished his speech yet?
37: ……210 的演讲结束了吗?

Sophia: Not yet, but you were sleeping so soundly just now that you were snoring a bit. I was worried they might hear you ...
苏菲亚: 还没有，只是你睡得太熟了，有些打鼾，我担心他们听见……

Sophia: And ... it doesn't seem polite to sleep during someone else's speech ...
苏菲亚： 而且……在别人演讲的时候睡觉，好像也不太好……

Sophia: Especially for 210, you know how much he enjoys delivering these lectures. He's always so concerned about whether he has the audience's attention ...
苏菲亚： 尤其是 210，他一向喜欢说话，也在乎人们是不是真的有在认真地听他说话……

Thirty-seven: Surely though it's worse to hinder others from acquiring knowledge like this?
37： 嗯……可是，难道耽误他人获取知识不是更不好的事吗?

Thirty-seven: Truth should neither rely on such rhetoric nor be so opaque in presentation. I fail to see how there could be any real knowledge in all this flamboyance.
37： 真理不该仰赖雄辩，也不该含混不清。我看不出这种华而不实的修辞里会有什么真正的知识。

Thirty-seven: *Yawn*, so you see, I'm simply lessening his sins ... At least the rhythm of his speech makes for a fine sleeping aid ...
37： 啊哈，我已经在尽量减少他的罪孽了……至少他谈话的韵律很适合入睡……

37 yawns softly and leans against Sophia.
37 小小地打了一个哈欠，靠在苏菲亚的身上。

Yet the rhetoric about fate, path, and glory of self-selection continues to pour into their ears.
可关于命运、道路、自我选择的辉煌一类的高谈阔论并没有绕过她们。

Thirty-seven: ...
37： ……

37 opens her eyes once more to see Sophia gazing forward intently beneath her red hair.
37 睁开眼睛，看见红发之下，苏菲亚认真向前注视的目光。

Thirty-seven: Are you truly so rapt by this topic?
37： 你对这个话题很感兴趣吗?

Sophia: ... I suppose I'm not sure yet.
苏菲亚： ……我也不太清楚。

Sophia: People have always cared about their fate, about what will happen tomorrow and the next day.
苏菲亚： 但人总会在乎自己的命运，在乎明天会发生什么。

Sophia: I don't know my own number yet. I don't understand my essence, let alone fate ...
苏菲亚： 我还没有自己的数字，还未了解自己的本质，更不清楚自己的命运……

Sophia's gaze drops to her clasped hands resting in her lap.
苏菲亚的视线下垂，看着自己放在膝盖上并拢的双手。

Sophia: His lecture does make sense: working hard and striving forward is obviously a good thing.
苏菲亚： 他说的事情有道理，努力地向前走未尝不是一件好事。

Sophia: But I feel like I still haven't found my way.
苏菲亚： 但是，我还未找到属于我的方向。

Sophia: I only just arrived here, there's still so much for me to learn ...
苏菲亚： 我刚到达这里不久，我要学习的事情还有许多……

Sophia's voice is subdued, fading until finally reaching a whisper.
年轻姑娘的声音渐渐地、渐渐地弱下去，沉闷下去，最终到达了一处低谷。

She takes a deep breath, as if to revitalize her spirit, and lifts her eyes to look at 37.
紧接着，她吸了一口气，像是重新振奋了精神，抬起眼睛望向身旁的朋友。

Sophia: What about you, 37? Aren't you curious at all about your fate?
苏菲亚：你呢？37，你不好奇你的命运……

Sophia: Ah ...
苏菲亚：啊……

Thirty-seven: ... Mhmm ...
37：……呼。

37 breathes out a steady huff.
呼吸平稳。

Thirty-seven: ○ ... is not the greatest prime number ...
37：〇……不是最大的素数……

Obviously, she needs sleep, and she is especially adept at falling into deep slumbers.
显而易见，年轻孩子需要睡眠，尤其擅长酣然入睡。

210's impassioned rhetoric is apparently so tedious to her that she can't hold her eyes open even another moment.
友人的激昂论调对她来说如此乏味，以至于难以维持片刻清醒。

210: "When the man lay sick in bed, he cried up to the voice from above, asking, 'When will all that you have promised finally arrive?'"
210：“那人缠绵病榻时，又对天上的声音询问，那件大事在何时发生?”

210: "The voice from above scorned him, saying, 'It has already come and gone, only you never sought it out.'"
210：“天上的声音回答他：一切早已发生，只是你未参与其中。”

210: "So the man lamented his cowardice, his idleness, and all the fortunes he had lost."
210：“于是那人悔恨，悔恨自己的胆怯，悔恨自己错失的命运。”

210: That's why we should be vigilant about our own fortunes. We must keep our vision clear, listen to our own voice, and not stagnate waiting for the promises of others.
210：所以我们应该警醒，我们要保持目光的清明，倾听自己的声音，而非怠惰地停滞。

210: If we succumb to cowardice, or complacency, even those gifts promised to us by fate can slip away.
210：如若恐惧、胆怯、故步自封，即使是命运中所注定的馈赠，也会轻易流逝。

210: Human innovation and knowledge come from courage, a thirst for truth, and constant curiosity.
210：而人的变革与新知，来源于勇气、求知的探索欲与源源不断的好奇之心。

210: It is for this reason that we must forge our own paths and control our own fates—
210：正是因此，我们才得以开拓道路，掌握自己的命运——

He raises his hand high, and the future rhetorician begins to emerge.
高举起手，未来修辞学家的模样已初现端倪。

As he makes his eloquent speech, a pile of seashells amasses before him, one by one, representing the audience's support.
一片，两片，慷慨陈词之下，少年人面前支持的海贝已堆起一座小丘。

He is satisfied, but not completely.
他对此满意，却不够满意。

210: Fate—yes, and as we're discussing fate, we cannot ignore the fate of those sitting among us.
210：命运——是的，我们既然探讨命运，就不能回避我们之中坐着的人。

210: Our star of Hermes, fell upon fate at birth, bringing us hope for enlightenment.
210：正如我们的赫尔墨斯之星，她出生便降落在命运之上，带来了启明的希望。

210: We could let her speak, to show her light hasn't diminished, but it seems sleep has taken hold of her, preventing her from shining.
210：我们可以让她来发表一番言论，因为她的光芒不曾消减，只是现在，睡梦拖住了她，让她无法闪耀。

210 turns around and points abruptly to the other side.
210 调转方向，突兀地指向另一侧。

210: But fortunately, there are still those among us who can represent the inevitability of fate.
210：但还好，我们之中仍有人足以代表命运。

He extends his hand, palm up, fingers forward, in an inviting gesture.
他伸出手，掌心向上，指尖向前，做出邀请的姿态。

The crowd disperses like startled fish, revealing a young man.
人群如受惊的游鱼一般散开几米，露出了淹没在其中的少年。

210: Come, Atticus, my friend—he who will receive the "revelation."
210：来吧，亚齐，我的朋友——将受“启示”之人。

210: You are destined to become the perfect number, to receive all the wisdom and all the promises due—our future leader of Apeiron.
210：你注定成为最完满的数字，将获得一切的智慧以及所有当有的应许——我们阿派朗未来的领导者。

210: Don't let silence swallow that light. Please articulate to us your views about fate and share your wisdom.
210：不要让沉默吞没那些光。请阐述那些有关命运的观点，请与我们分享你的智慧。

The young man, given a prestigious title, does not stand out in the crowd. His gaze slides over the inviting hand and rests on an empty spot in the air beside it.
被赋予颇长头衔的男孩在人群中并不突出。他的目光在邀请的手掌之上滑过，停留在它旁边的一处空气上。

Atticus: This is your speech, not mine, 210.
亚齐：这并非我的演讲，210。

210: But surely no one understands fate better than you, our perfect "6", awaiting the arrival of your fate every moment, every day.
210：可没有人比你更了解命运，你每时每刻都浸泡在完美的“6”之中等待着它的到来。

The young orator holds the moment with anticipation—yes, if anyone deserves to show wisdom comparable to his own it would be his present target.
年轻的雄辩者等待着——是的，对方理应有着可以与自己媲美的智慧。

He greedily seeks the arrival of what he imagines to be an evenly-matched debate.
可以预见，这应是一场令人喜悦的、势均力敌的酣畅辩论。

Atticus: ... I ...
亚齐：……我……

All eyes move to surround Atticus. Accustomed to being invisible in a crowd, he attempts to turn slightly as if to escape the challenge and the weight of their gaze.
周围的目光显然令这位惯于隐没在人群中的少年感到不适，他甚至微微侧身，试图以动作辅助自己表达抗拒。

Sophia: Hmm, Atticus doesn't seem too happy. What is this "revelation" that 210 is talking about?
苏菲亚：唔，亚齐看起来不太高兴……210 说的“启示”是什么?

Thirty-seven: Oh nothing important. Just a lot of nonsense.
37：没什么大不了的，只是一个故弄玄虚的词。

Thirty-seven: All leaders are supposed to receive a special "revelation" when their soul numbers are revealed. It's the sign of a 6's succession to leadership.
37：在每一任学派领袖的灵魂数字出现时，他们会得到某个不传的“指示”。这是他们继任的征兆……

Thirty-seven: Like the oracle of Apollo in Delphi.
37：就像是人们以前在德尔斐的神庙里聆听阿波罗的神谕。

The commotion must have disturbed her sleep, or perhaps it is the peacocking of the orator that awakens her.
喧闹让女孩儿睡得并不踏实，也或许是她对那样张扬似孔雀的演讲者有所不满。

Sophia: It all sounds incredible. Are you saying they can hear the voice of the gods ... ? Or is this something about numbers ... ?
苏菲亚：这，这听起来很了不起。你是说他们能听到神的声音么……？还是数字之类的……?

The redhead, still new to the island, seems in awe.
初来岛上不久的红发女孩发出惊叹的低呼。

However, 37 thinks it's no big deal.
她的同伴对此却不以为意。

Thirty-seven: But the leader's number has always been 6, so there's nothing new about this "revelation." We already know the outcome.
37：可每一任学派领袖的数字都是 6，所以这指示没有什么新奇的——我们早就知道结果了。

Thirty-seven: 210 uses far too many meaningless words. Why not just call him 6?
37：210 用了太多无意义的修辞。何不直接称他为 6 呢?

Sophia: You mean, call Atticus 6? But isn't the current 6 "that person" ...?
苏菲亚：你是说亚齐？可 6……6 不是那位……?

Thirty-seven: Oh, yes, Atticus hasn't received the "revelation" yet.
37：噢，是的，他还没有接受“启示”。

Thirty-seven: But he will be 6 eventually. It's in his destiny.
37：但他早晚都会是 6 的，因为这是他的本质。

Atticus: —I don't really know about that.
亚齐：——我没有任何看法。

The young man's voice grows louder, interrupting the distant whispers.
男孩的声音变得高了些，打断了远处的窃窃私语。

Sophia: ... !
苏菲亚：……!

210: How can that be?
210：怎么会?

210: You are number 6, we all know. You will become number 6 and possess everything a 6 should have—infinite wisdom, supreme vision, a sharp mind, and the poise of a leader.
210：你是数字 6，我们都知道。你将成为数字 6，拥有一个 6 应当拥有的一切——无穷的智慧、无上的视界、敏锐的思维与领导者的气魄。

210: Since you inherited the bloodline of the prophecy, your "revelation" has been predestined since your birth. It's even more clear than a voice from above.
210：因为你继承了预言中的血脉，“启示”自你降生时已注定，甚至比天上的声音更加明晰。

210: See how similar you are to the person in the story. You both heard the prophecy, and you both know your own fates.
210：瞧瞧吧——你与故事中的人何其相似。你们都听到了预言，也都已知晓了自身的命运。

210: What did you gain from it? And what did you hear?
210：你从中得到了什么，又听到了什么？

It is a bold challenge.
这是一场冲锋。

A verbal challenge from the proud peacock to the island's future leader.
由骄傲的、羽翼渐丰的雄鸟向这座岛上预备的领导者发起的诘问。

210: You didn't throw your seashell; I want to know why, perhaps you can illuminate some of your ever hidden thoughts.
210：你并未投掷你的海贝，我想知道其中的原因，也想了解与我不同的想法。

210: My friend, it is through the clashing of minds in a debate that we can gain a deeper understanding of one another. I pray you will share—
210：朋友，思想在辩论中交锋，我们能从中相互获得更多，我希望你能够分享——

"Clack."
“当啷。”

210: ...
210：……

His speech is interrupted by a crisp clattering sound. He looks down to see a new addition to the seashells at his feet. His hoped-for opponent gently tossed his "challenge" aside along with the shell.
话头被清脆的声响打断。他低下头，看见高耸的海贝顶端迎来了新的加入者——对方将他的“战书”同这枚海贝一起轻轻抛掷在他的脚尖。

210 cannot read anything other than "humiliation" in the shell.
——210 读不出这枚海贝除“羞辱”以外的其他含义。

Atticus: You misunderstand, 210. I have no thoughts on fate ...
亚齐：你理解错了。对于命运，我没有想法……

Atticus finally meets his gaze.
亚齐终于应向对方的目光。

Atticus: I don't have an answer to your question.
亚齐：我对此也无话可说。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

玻璃瓶
A Bottle COL-307902

A Bottle
玻璃瓶

That time, we parted on poor terms.
那次，我们不欢而散。

After a long while, I grew taller, the hem of my dress had risen from my ankles to my calves, and Atticus and I brought up that avoided debate again.
许久之后，我长高了个子，裙边从脚踝上升到小腿，我与亚齐才再次提起了那场被回避了的辩论。

Sophia: Atticus, Atticus!
苏菲亚： 亚齐……亚齐！

When I found Atticus, he was, as usual, wandering alone on the beach.
我发现亚齐的时候，他与往常一样，独自在沙滩上游荡。

I always found him there early in the morning, so if I needed to speak with him, I would come here at the same time.
他总在清晨来这里，所以当我需要寻找他的时候，我总会在清晨来这里。

Atticus: Good morning, Sophia.
亚齐： 早上好，苏菲亚。

He was bringing a stranded fish back into the sea, as it flashed from his hands he gave me a smile.
他将一只搁浅的鱼儿丢入海中，向我露出一个微笑。

Sophia: Good morning.
苏菲亚： 早上好。

Of all the people on the Island, Atticus was the one I could communicate with the easiest.
亚齐是这座岛上与我交流得最顺畅的人。

It wasn't anyone else's fault—Apeiron operated on its own set of rules to maintain stability. It was always going to be difficult for an outsider to break into their tight-knit community.
但这并非是其他人的问题——阿派朗有着一套独属于自己的规律，他们因此而平稳运转。外来者想要融入如此严丝合缝的逻辑之间，显然需要一定的时间与努力。

But my visits to the beach were not just to see him.
但在那段时间里，我前往沙滩，并不总是为了找他。

Atticus: Are you here to collect your sand again today?
亚齐： 你今天仍旧是来装细沙的?

Sophia: Yes. The fine sand here is ideal for polishing lenses. My father's eyeglasses are just about ready.
苏菲亚： 是的，细沙子可以很好地打磨镜片，那副眼镜就快要做好了。

Sophia: His eyesight has been deteriorating more and more. I hope these will help.
苏菲亚： 我希望它能让爸爸的眼睛看清楚些，他的视力一直在下降。

Sophia: ...
苏菲亚： ……

Maybe it's because of my father's health, I feel more upset and sensitive than usual.
也许是因为父亲身体的缘故，我比往日更加忧郁、感性。

This is not a good time to confide.
这不是一个倾诉的好时机。

Sophia: This morning, he woke up and asked me why it was still dark. Hadn't the day arrived yet?
苏菲亚： 他今天早晨醒来，然后问我，为什么现在还是黑夜？难道白昼没有到来？

Sophia: I worry, worry that the glasses won't keep up with his decline, or perhaps that they were never going to help him ...
苏菲亚： 我担心，担心这副眼镜赶不上爸爸眼睛坏掉的速度，或者说，它从来就不能帮助他……

Atticus: Hmm ...
亚齐： 嗯……

Atticus: And yet, you still made them.
亚齐： 但你还是如此做了。

Sophia: ... ?
苏菲亚： ……?

I'm pretty sure it is a declarative sentence, yet I sense his confusion inside—more confusion than in any question.
我不甚确定，那应当是一句毫无波澜的陈述句。但我却在其中感受到了他的困惑……比任何一句疑问句之中蕴含的疑惑都要丰富。

But I'm not always right, especially on this island. So, perhaps I'm imagining things.
但我不总是对的，尤其是在这座岛上。所以这很可能只是一个错觉。

Sophia: ...
苏菲亚： ……

Atticus: ...
亚齐： ……

I stop speaking, knowing that sharing my worries over my father will do nothing to lessen them. The sea breeze blows over us. Each seagull's cry is distinct and loud.
我止住了话头，这份对于父亲的担心很难从分享中获得减轻。海风从我们身侧吹过，海鸥的鸣叫在此刻分外清晰。

Sophia: ...
苏菲亚： ……

In the school, such unusual quietness often causes an uneasy feeling in my heart—anxiety.
在学派里，我常因这样异常的安静而感到心口泛酸——那是一种名为焦虑的情绪。

But now, despite the silence between us, my breathing is even. This peace of the moment feels comforting.
但此刻，我的心跳平静，呼吸平和。这份安宁，令人如此舒适。

Atticus: ...
亚齐： ……

Time passes in hours as the sunlight reaches overhead near its zenith. At last, Atticus stands up.
不知过了多久，日光逐渐移到了头顶。亚齐站起身来。

Sophia: Are you leaving?
苏菲亚： 你要走了吗?

Atticus: Yes, it's nearly lunchtime.
亚齐： 是的，已近午时，快到用餐的时间了。

Sophia: ... Huh? But it's still early yet? Are you hungry?
苏菲亚： ……呃？好像……还有一段时间？你饿了吗?

Atticus: ... No.
亚齐： ……不。

He shakes his head slightly, a bit uneasy.
他略显局促地摇了摇头。

Atticus: I need to go early, or there won't be any quiet spots left.
亚齐：我需要早点过去，不然角落的位置就要没有了。

I realize now why I rarely encounter him on the other routes I walk.
我恍然。怪不得，我很难在一些其他的必经之路上遇到他。

Sophia: Why don't you sit with us?
苏菲亚：你为什么不同我们一起呢?

Sophia: ... Is it because of 210?
苏菲亚：……是因为 210 吗?

I ask softly, then immediately regret it, realizing that my inappropriate question would only cause awkwardness.
我下意识地轻声提问，随即意识到这句话并不得体，只会招致他人的尴尬。

Sophia: ... Oh, sorry, I didn't mean to ...
苏菲亚：……哦，对不起，我不是这个意思……

Panic occupies my mind, and I struggle to come up with a suitable excuse.
慌张占据了我的大脑，我没能想出更得体的借口来掩饰。

Atticus: No.
亚齐：不。

Atticus's response surprises me. He gently shakes his head.
亚齐的反应在我意料之外，他轻轻摇了摇头。

Atticus: I'm not specifically trying to avoid him.
亚齐：我并没有特别地要避开他。

As if sensing my guilt, he smiles.
似乎是感受到我的愧疚，他露出一个微笑。

Atticus: Before 210 was 210, he didn't look kindly on me—of course, that has to do with his competitive nature, which I never minded.
亚齐：在 210 还不是 210 的时候，他也并未以友善的目光看待我——当然，这与他好胜的性格脱不开干系，我并未介意过。

Atticus: Then he became 210—a number easily factored ... And well everything that came next feels terribly predictable.
亚齐：后来他成为了 210——那是一个很好被因式分解的数字……之后的事情，也并不奇怪。

He looks down at the sand, then lifts his head again.
他低下头看了看沙子，不知怎么，又抬起头来。

Atticus: I know why you asked, Sophia. Please don't take it too hard. That speech was just a trigger ... Our interactions have always been like this.
亚齐：我知道你为什么会这样问，苏菲亚，请别太过将它放在心上。那次演讲只能算是个导火索……我们相处的模式本就如此而已。

Sophia: Hmm ...
苏菲亚：嗯……

I try to remember the debate that came out of nowhere.
我试着回忆那次突如其来的辩论。

Sophia: I don't quite understand ...
苏菲亚：我不太明白……

Sophia: When I first arrived here, you took such excellent care of me.
苏菲亚：在我刚到这里的时候，你照顾过我很多。

Sophia: And you, 210, and 37 grew up together as friends ...
苏菲亚：而且，210、你，还有 37，是一起长大的朋友……

Sophia: But then ... after your debate with him ...
苏菲亚：但那时……你和他的辩论……

Atticus: ...
亚齐：……

Atticus: I was young then and I was flippant in my behavior—I provoked him, given his character, I knew he would take it as a humiliation.
亚齐：我那时年幼，在行为上有所疏忽——以他的性格，自然会把那理解为羞辱和挑衅。

Atticus: It was my decision, so I must accept the consequences of it.
亚齐：这是我的选择所致，所以现在的结果，我应当接受。

Atticus: But that wasn't a debate, Sophia. He didn't want my point of view.
亚齐：但那不是一场辩论，苏菲亚。因为他所真正期待的并不是我的观点。

Atticus's voice and manner are as calm and cool as the sea breeze.
亚齐的声音平缓，情绪温和。

His description of his conflict with 210 feels more like it came from a distant observer.
比起谈论自己与朋友的矛盾，他的态度更像是一个远眺的局外人。

Atticus: I know him, and I know myself. We think differently.
亚齐：我了解他，也了解我自己，我们的想法不同。

Atticus: He is not in need of an exchange of ideas.
亚齐：他并非需要思想的交换。

Atticus: In fact, he's not at all interested in what I think. He just wants a victory.
亚齐：实际上，他对我的想法并无兴趣，他需要的只是一场胜利而已。

Sophia: ... He is competitive.
苏菲亚：……他的确是个争强好胜的人。

His tone remains even, almost emotionless.
他语气平和。

Atticus: An exchange of ideas like that is purposeless. Each side will stick to their own opinions, vainly trapped in position. In the end, there is no mutual understanding. It only further reinforces their own defenses.
亚齐：这样的交流是无意义的。人们各执一词，徒劳地困于自己的立场。最终，他们也并未互相理解分毫，只是加深了自我的防壁。

He sighs, the confusion surfacing again.
他叹了口气，那份困惑又一次冒出了头。

Atticus: I've tried and tried, but people always step into the same river over and over again.
亚齐：我尝试过，努力过，但人们总是反复踏入同样的河流。

Atticus: Facing this inevitable end, any action at all seems futile.
亚齐：面对必将到达的终点，行为是如此徒劳。

Sophia: ...
苏菲亚：……

I'm not sure what to say; his words hold merit—but I, I somehow feel ...
我不确定自己应该说些什么，他的话语不无道理——但我，我总觉得……

Sophia: I ...
苏菲亚：我……

Before I can utter another word, Atticus asks me a pointed question.
在我发出声音前，亚齐问了我一个问题。

Atticus: Sophia, you're smart. You know enough about your father's health.
亚齐：苏菲亚，你一直很聪明，你知道你父亲的身体情况。

Atticus: You also know those glasses won't be of much help to him.
亚齐：你也知道那副眼镜帮不上太大的忙。

Atticus: ... Why do you choose to struggle so much against the path of fate?
亚齐：……你为什么会选择在命运的道路上如此挣扎?

It's an offensive question, and I feel at first I should be uncomfortable with it.
这是一个相当冒犯的问题，我应该为此感到不适。

But I know it's different with Atticus. His confusion is genuine, not mocking or cruel.
但我知道这不一样，亚齐不一样。他的困惑货真价实——那不是我的错觉。

Sophia: ...
苏菲亚：……

I rarely have the opportunity to mentor others on this island. The whole thing is unfamiliar to me.
在这个岛上，我鲜少有指导他人的机会，我不熟悉这个。

Sophia: ... I don't know.
苏菲亚：……我也不知道。

I regret my response. It is too hasty, too dismissive.
我感到后悔——这样的回答太敷衍了。

In fact, I have the real reason clear in my mind.
实际上，我当时明确想到了原因。

When my mother was dying of her illness, I felt so powerless. I know I don't want to experience that a second time.
我的母亲在我年幼时因病早逝，我只是……不想再体会第二次那种无能为力的感觉。

Sophia: ... I have to do something, anything.
苏菲亚：……我总得做点什么，不论什么都好。

I take a deep breath, trying to gather my scattered thoughts.
我深呼吸了一口气，试图拉回破碎的思绪。

Sophia: You're right, Atticus. Even with effort, we can't avoid the inevitable.
苏菲亚：你说的是对的，亚齐，即使人做出努力也无法回避必将发生的结局。

Sophia: But I think, we can't just sit around and do nothing about it ...
苏菲亚：但我想，我们不能只是看着结果到来……

Atticus: ... ?
亚齐：……?

The inquisition in his eyes is piercing. I feel suddenly I have to explain it in their way.
探寻的目光令我无所适从，于是试图模仿他们的方式去讲述。

Sophia: Preparing for the inevitable is like ... preparing a psalm for a morning class.
苏菲亚：为即将到来的事物做准备，就像是……为早课准备诗篇。

Sophia: Practicing and familiarizing oneself with upcoming difficulties makes it easier to face them ...
苏菲亚：预先演习和熟悉将要面对的困难，至少能让我面对它的时候感到轻松一些……

I feel I don't often, or rather, I lack the time to really consider meaning.
是的，我不常，或者说，我没有考虑意义的空隙。

Sometimes, the quality that allows us to face our fate isn't necessarily courage—it might just be the fear of the truth.
有时候，让人得以面对既定结局的品质不一定是勇气——也有可能是对真相的畏惧。

Perhaps I'm destined to forget that lengthy psalm. Perhaps there's nothing I can do for my father ...
或许我注定遗忘那篇冗长的诗文，或许父亲，真的……

Sophia: ... But preparing for what must come is better than doing nothing at all.
苏菲亚：……面对即将要发生的事，做些准备，总比不做准备要来得更好。

But giving hope to others must be done in the name of "courage," if nothing else.
但鼓励他人，仍需要假借“勇气”的名义。

Sophia: If a glass bottle on the table is destined to fall, I would put a cloth on the floor around it. So even if the bottle does break, the mess will be easier to clean.
苏菲亚：如果桌子上的水瓶必将跌落在地上，那我会在周边的地上铺好棉垫，即使水瓶仍旧有可能破碎，但这么一来，残渣也会好收拾许多。

Atticus: ...
亚齐：……

I turn to look at Atticus. He's frowning, as if pondering my words.
我侧头看向他。亚齐皱起眉头，似乎在思考我说的话。

Sophia: Atticus, you don't actually want to answer that question, do you?
苏菲亚：亚齐，其实你也并不想回答那个问题，对吗?

I speculate on his thoughts, and this is also offensive.
我擅自揣测了他，这应当也是冒犯的。

Sophia: I've heard from 37 and others in the school about this "revelation" ... I don't understand what it is exactly, but they say it's a gift of fate.
苏菲亚：我从 37 和其他学派内的兄弟姊妹那里听说过，那个“启示”……我不明白那具体是什么，但他们说，那是命运的赠礼。

Just like that voice from above, the "revelation" promises all the wisdom of the world to the 6s of each generation.
就如同那道天上的声音，“启示”许诺给历代 6 有关世界的一切智慧。

Sophia: But ...
苏菲亚：可是……

I try to express everything I feel.
我试图将我感受到的一切说出来。

Sophia: Do you fear it?
苏菲亚：——你在畏惧它吗?

Atticus: ...
亚齐：……

Atticus: I don't know.
亚齐：我不知道。

His voice is so faint that the words almost feel illusory, like a false memory, then it begins to roar.
他的声音极轻，我几乎感觉这句话是我的幻觉，是段不存在的回忆。

Atticus: If this gift is from the above, and it never asks for your own desires or cares about your existence, can it still be called a "gift"?
亚齐：如果这天上的赠礼从未过问你的意志，也不关心你的存在，那么它还能称之为“赠礼”吗？

Atticus: --Do we really have no choice but to kneel before destiny, begging for its love and mercy?
亚齐：——难道命运随手丢给我们一块肉骨头，我们就必须在它的脚边摇尾乞怜么？

Atticus's hand trembles slightly.
亚齐的手轻微颤抖着。

I'm surprised by the rage and intensity in his voice. I've never seen him so upset.
我感到意外，我从未看到他如此激动的时候，更未想到他会说出如此激烈的言语。

The people of the island are generally reserved due to their intelligence. 210 is an outlier, but Atticus's words are still sharper.
岛上的人们普遍因智慧而温和，210 已是他们中的突出者。亚齐的话却比这更加尖锐。

Maybe this is the perspective he held back from that debate.
也许这才是他在那场辩论中未说出口的观念。

Atticus: So I turn away from the table. I don't want to see whether the bottle is teetering.
亚齐：……于是我只是背向那张桌子，不去考虑水瓶是否摇摇欲坠。

Atticus finally looks at the fine sand in my hand.
亚齐最终看向了我手中的细沙。

Atticus: But I think you're right.
亚齐：但我想你是对的。

I only remember that at the end of our conversation, he came towards me with a kind of expression on his face.
我只记得在谈话的最后，他向我走来，脸上带着一些表情。

That expression was like a smile, yet also like sorrow or perhaps relief—a face filled with determination.
那表情像是笑容，也像是愁苦，又好似释然，总之，那是一张下定了决心的脸。

Atticus: Thank you for telling me all this, Sophia.
亚齐：谢谢你对我说这么多，苏菲亚。

Sophia: And thank you for listening to me, Atticus.
苏菲亚：也谢谢你愿意听我说这些话，亚齐。

We said goodbye as we did countless times before, not affectionately, but also not quite distantly.
我们像是过去无数次一样地告别，不亲热，也不疏远。

I returned downhill to my home to continue making the lenses, lenses I knew would never be of any use to my father.
我返回我处于下坡的家，为我的父亲制作那枚派不上用场的镜片。

He went uphill to his home, back to the brilliance of the current "6" in her supreme wisdom.
他返回他位于高坡上的家，回到现任“6”无上智慧的光芒照耀中去。

Sophia: ...
苏菲亚：……

Sophia: Goodbye!
苏菲亚：再见！

I don't know why I said goodbye to Atticus.
我不知道我为什么要对亚齐告别。

Atticus: ...
亚齐：……

He turned back, nodding his head in acknowledgment.
而他只是回头，给予我一个颔首的示意。

After that, I have never seen Atticus walking on the beach again.
在那之后，我再也没有见过亚齐在海滩上行走。

He began his long retreat.
他开始了漫长的闭关。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

牡蛎壳儿
An Oyster Shell COL-307903

An Oyster Shell
牡蛎壳儿

Believer : It's time for us to go.
教众： 已经是时候了，我们该启程了。

I took a deep breath and adjusted the grapevine on my head, trying to make it look as symmetrical as possible.
我深吸一口气，调整好头上的葡萄藤，尽可能地使它看起来对称一些。

In my youth, the third weekend of each month with an even-numbered date was the happiest for me.
在我年少时，每月第三个日期为双数的周末本是我最为愉快的时光。

210: Let's go, I'm ready.
210： 出发吧，我已经做好了准备。

It was a day of speculation when the 6's coordinator invited the island's finest youths to talks.
那是一个思辨之日，6 的协理者会邀请这座岛屿上优秀的年轻人们前往会谈。

They would not overlook me, just as a girl collecting shells on the beach wouldn't miss a pearlescent oyster.
他们不会落下我，就像是在沙滩上捡贝壳的姑娘不会遗漏一枚珠蚌。

Believer : ... Hm?
教众： ……嗯?

The usually bustling square is deserted, and I, along with a few other students, pause outside.
本应喧嚣的广场空无一人，我与其余几位年轻人停驻在外。

Believer : One moment, let me inquire about the situation.
教众： 请稍等，让我去询问一下情况。

Thirty-seven: ... Haah.
37： ……哈啊。

210: It seems our Star of Hermes is in need of some sleep. You ought to keep an eye on the time; that's a number as well.
210： 看起来我们的赫尔墨斯之星欠缺睡眠，你需要注意时间，那也是一种数字。

210: At least, time is counted in numbers. You like numbers.
210：至少它们也获得了数字的名，你总是喜欢数字的。

Thirty-seven: I can see everyone's number, but I never said I liked all numbers.
37：我只是能看见数字，我从没有说过我喜欢所有数字。

210: I hope you aren't about to say you dislike 210.
210：我希望你不会说，你所讨厌的那个数字是 210。

Thirty-seven: Hah ...
37：哈……

Thirty-seven: Irrelevant to my likes and dislikes, 210 is simply a poor number.
37：无关我的喜恶，即使只看向 210，那也是一个很差的数字。

Thirty-seven: It has four prime factors yet lacks a solid base, so it's prone to deformation like a rhombus.
37：它有四个质因数，却没有一个坚实的基底，就像菱形一样容易形变。

210: Well, it is no surprise. We know prime numbers are born unique, standing like the cornerstones of all others. Composite numbers are slightly inferior, like frivolous and fast-decaying paintings.
210：噢，毫不意外的评价。毕竟我们知道，质数生而独特，是构成所有数字的基石。合数则棋差一着，如轻浮而速朽的装饰画。

Thirty-seven: Why bring up all the prime numbers and composites numbers? We're just talking about 210.
37：为什么说到质数和合数？我们在谈论的只是 210。

Thirty-seven: I don't understand your methodology.
37：我不明白你想说什么。

Thirty-seven: And I don't understand why you always call me the Star of Hermes. Is it because Hermes is the Thrice-Greatest and he has his Seven Hermetic Principles?
37：我也不明白你为何总是称呼我为赫尔墨斯之星……难道是因为三重伟大的赫尔墨斯和他的七大宇宙法则吗？

Thirty-seven: I am 37, not 3 and 7. They are not the same conceptually. You shouldn't make such a fundamental mistake in your understanding of numbers.
37：可我是 37，不是 3 和 7。你不该犯下这种完全不了解数学的基础错误！

It is hardly a pleasant chat. My relationship with 37 has never been harmonious.
那是一场不算愉快的聊天，我与 37 的关系向来不算融洽。

But we've grown accustomed to this bantering tete-a-tete, always attacking each other. That's just how we interact.
但我们习惯这种关系，互相揶揄、攻击，这就是我们的相处方式。

The familiarity of it all breeds contempt. As we walk down the same old paths, arguing over things we've debated hundreds of times.
人不会厌恶惯常出现的事物，我们熟练地走入相同的道路，相互辩驳过上百次的内容。

But it is on these familiar paths that a moment of boldness can make the most change.
但有些突变，正是在熟悉的道路上发生的。

Believer : I'm sorry, you two might have to wait a little longer.
教众：很抱歉，你们两位可能还要再等一段时间。

Believer: 6 isn't ready for you yet, but she won't need much time. You can follow me to the gazebo under the grapevines to sit in the shade and wait for your meeting.
教众：6 还未做好与你们对谈的准备，但她需要的时间并不算长，你们可以跟我来，到葡萄藤下的凉亭处躲避日光，等待会面。

Thirty-seven: Her first time being late in all these years.
37：这么多年来，她第一次迟到。

37 follows 6's coordinator, moving at pace towards the vine-draped gazebo.
37 跟随在 6 的协理者身后，身形轻快，向着绿茵藤下走去。

Meanwhile my steps are hesitant, my thoughts have become a mess.
而我的脚步迟疑，思绪混乱。

210: Is our leader ill?
210：她生病了吗?

The unease from the anomaly spreads in my mind. Everyone on the island knows that the leader's health is in irreversible decline.
异常带来的不安在心中蔓延，岛屿上的每个人都知道，领导者的身体状况正在无可挽救的衰落。

Excellence often invites the envy of fate.
杰出总是容易招致命运的妒恨。

The lifespan of each 6 has been lamentably short. Atticus's mother, the previous 6, left this world when he was still young.
历任 6 的寿命都短得令人唏嘘。上一任 6——也就是亚齐的母亲，在他尚且年幼的时候就撒手人寰。

Then, the current 6 received the "revelation," becoming the new leader of the school—and, of course, in my opinion, the finest leader.
而后，现任的 6 获得了“启示”，成为了学派新的领袖——当然，也是我认为的，最优秀的领导者。

6, perfect, balanced, and harmonious. She explores the form of Forms and traverses the hidden figures of the universe.
6 完美，匀称，和谐。她博览形式的形式，遍历宇宙的声音。

One night I wondered, how many more times would I be able to converse with her?
我曾经在一个夜晚想过，我还能与她对谈几次?

So filled with wisdom, unique understanding, bold hypotheses, and the courage to seek out the new and novel and not be complacent.
充满智慧，与众不同的理解，大胆的假设，求新求异而不故步自封的勇敢。

She deserves all her respect and adoration.
她值得这些尊敬与爱戴。

210: Maybe we can go back and visit her again when she's feeling better.
210：或许我们可以先回去，等到她的身体好一些了再来拜访。

210: I'm willing to make time for this discussion, whenever it may be.
210：无论什么时候，我都愿意为这场对谈腾出时间。

Emotions lead to rashness, and rationality is associated with calmness.
感情带来莽撞，而理智联系冷静。

I have ignored the coordinator's expression, his lips mumbling like the tide coming in and out on the shore.
我忽视了协理者的表情，他的嘴唇嗫嚅着，像是海岸上扑来又退去的潮水。

Believer: No, it's not because of that.
教众：不，不是因为如此。

Believer : You two rest here. When it's time for the meeting, I'll let you know.
教众： 你们在这里休息吧，等会面的时候到了，我会出来告知你们的。

Thirty-seven: Alright, I suppose I can take a stroll here while we wait—
37： 好吧，等待时间，我可以先在这儿转转——

Thirty-seven: What a pity ... it's not in season yet. If it were, we could have picked some grapes to eat.
37： 真可惜……季节还没到，如果到了季节，我们就可以摘一些葡萄吃了。

210: ...
210： ……

210: 37, did you hear something?
210： 37，你有没有听到什么声音?

Thirty-seven: Hm?
37： 嗯?

Thirty-seven: Hm, yeah, I heard something too, but it was vague and muffled—
37： 嗯——是的，没错，我也听到了一些声音，模模糊糊的，听不清楚——

Thirty-seven: I think it's over there, deeper in the grapevines.
37： 好像在那边，葡萄藤深一些的地方，让我们过去看看。

The Star of Hermes, so quick to act upon her thoughts.
赫尔墨斯星如此灵动，她想到，就做到。

I follow her, stepping deeper into the vine-laden arbor. Until we find a door left ajar.
我跟在她的身后，一步步踏入葡萄藤架的深处，最终，我们找到了一扇留了窄缝的门。

An unintentional but fortuitous encounter.
那是无心之失，但也是一场恰巧的偶遇。

Thirty-seven: It is Atticus. I haven't seen him in so long!
37： 是亚齐——真稀奇，我已经好久没能见过他了!

She spots our childhood friend, his pale face obscured beneath a mop of light blonde hair.
她瞧见我们从小一起长大的朋友，以及他那浅金色头发覆盖之下苍白的脸。

Thirty-seven: 6 is talking to Atticus. I heard Atticus hardly comes out during his retreat, unlike 6, who does so every other week.
37： 6 原来是在和他聊天呀，我听说他闭关后几乎从不出门，可不像 6 一样，每隔一周就出来一次……

Thirty-seven: Now you don't have to worry about 6. She may look pale, but at least she has the strength to talk.
37： 这下你不用担心 6 了，她虽然看起来脸色不好，但是最起码还有力气交谈。

Thirty-seven: She's just delayed a bit because she is talking with Atticus.
37： 她只是在和亚齐说话，才耽误了一些时间。

Despite 37's words, it's clear 6's health is more fragile than before. Her face is paler than Atticus's, and her voice is faint, merging into the air like gentle rain into water.
6 的身体比过去更虚弱了。她的脸色比亚齐更白，声音微弱，一落入空气中，就像是水溶于水中。

I can see her lips moving, but I can't hear her voice.
我能看见她的嘴唇开合，却听不见她的声音。

She reaches out a hand, weakly grasping the hem of Atticus's shirt, and pulls back.
她伸出一只手，拉住亚齐的衣摆，无力地向后拖拽。

Atticus: Hm.
亚齐： 嗯。

6s all have similar appearances, with their talents depending on hereditary blood—blonde hair, slender figures, pale skin, and wizened eyes.
6 都有相似的面目，他们的天赋依靠着血源继承。
金发，纤细的身形，苍白的皮肤，细而垂的眼。

They're like idols carved from the same mold, perfect reflections of a flawless lineage.
他们像是一个模子中刻出来的偶像，完美而无缺憾。

Six: ——, ————, — ...
6：——、————，——……

210: ...
210：……

She leans forward, a posture not easy for her in her current state.
她努力向眼前的身影倾着身子，那样的姿势对现在的她来说并不容易。

Our friend, Atticus, remains standing upright, his eyes looking into space, as if indifferent and utterly devoid of respect.
而我们的朋友，亚齐，他仍旧冷漠且挺拔地站着，眼神望着空气——毫无尊重。

Atticus: ...
亚齐：……

I'm not sure if there's fear in those eyes, but I'm certain of the anger echoing in my chest in reaction to this rude silence. It is an irritation not easily soothed.
我不确定那双眼睛里是不是有畏惧，但我可以确定的是，我的胸腔里因为这份无礼的沉默回荡着无法被轻易纾解的怒气。

Disregard—It is the greatest disrespect and insult, a taste like bad wine. I've tasted it before, and, coincidentally, that bad wine was also a "gift" from this very same cold "statue" that stands before me.
忽略——这是最大的不敬与侮辱，我曾亲口品尝过它的辛辣，像是酿造不当的次级葡萄酒。而这杯酒，好巧不巧，同样是眼前的这尊“雕塑”赐予的礼物。

I could forgive his rudeness towards me—but he shouldn't treat 6 this way.
我尚且可以原谅那份针对我的无礼——但他不应当这样对待 6。

6 has always selflessly guided us in the pursuit of Truth, setting us straight when the path forward is not clear.
6 一直都无私地引导我们追寻真理，为我们拨开迷雾遮挡的方向。

On top of that, she is Atticus's aunt. After the previous 6 returned to the Truth, she took over, caring for Atticus as a mother would.
除此之外，她还是亚齐的姨妈。在上任 6 回归真理之后，她便代替了那位年轻的母亲，照料着亚齐。

Thirty-seven: Um ...
37：哎呀……

That "sculpted" young hand, covering the slightly wrinkled one, pulls the hem free.
那只雕塑般的、年轻的手，覆盖在略有纹路的手之上，将衣摆从中抽出。

So disrespectful, so rude.
如此无礼，如此粗鲁。

Atticus draws away and steps through the narrow door. The gaze from his kin follows him in silence until it is cut off by the door panel.
亚齐抽身离开，从窄门中走出，来自于他血亲的目光沉默地跟随，而后被门板截断。

Atticus: You ... what are you doing here?
亚齐：你们……怎么会在这里?

Surprise flickers across his face. He looks strangely tired.
惊讶在他脸上滑过，意外地，他看上去有些疲惫。

210: We have more right to be here than you. It's the third weekend of the month and an even date.
210：我们比你更合适出现在这里，这是每月第三个日期为双数的周末。

Atticus: ... I see.
亚齐：……原来如此。

He nods absently, intending to leave without another word.
他神情恍惚地点点头，打算从我们身侧离开。

210: Stop.
210：停下。

He shouldn't be allowed to just slip away without any criticism.
他不该就这样蒙混过关，而不得到任何斥责。

Atticus: ... ?
亚齐：……?

My anger is more than justified. He shouldn't have done that to her.
我的愤慨如此理所当然，他做了他的身份不该做的事。

To treat the island's leader this way, a wise person, his own kin, an elder in failing health—
对待岛屿的领导者，对待一位智者，对待自己的血亲，对待一位身体衰弱的长辈——

How could he do this?
他怎么能这样做?

How?
怎么能?

210: I'm curious, do you even have any self-awareness?
210：我很好奇，你究竟对自己有没有认知?

Atticus: ... What do you mean?
亚齐：……你什么意思?

210: I think my question is clear enough.
210：我的提问非常直白。

I meet Atticus's gaze, more than satisfied that I've finally broken his calm.
我迎上亚齐的目光——我很满意，这次它不再平静了。

210: Atticus, my friend, everyone on this island knows that you were born a 6 and are destined to become the leader of Apeiron.
210：亚齐，我的朋友，这岛上的每一个人都知道，你生来也是一个 6，以后注定成为阿派朗的领袖。

210: —Destined to receive the "revelation".
210：——注定迎来“启示”。

Atticus: ...
亚齐：……

210: Do you even understand the weight of this blessing?
210：你究竟懂不懂这份祝福的分量?

Atticus: 210, I don't have time for your debate.
亚齐：……210，我没有时间参与你的辩论。

210: This isn't a debate; I'm trying to offer you some help.
210：我并不是要与你辩论，而是要为你提供一些帮助。

I have narrowed in on him, no more room for him to evade me.
他休想再像那时一样逃避。

210: A mission bestowed from the heavens ... You'll receive the great number, and become the mediator between excess and deficit.
210：伟大的圆满，上天所赋予的使命，你会获得一个好数字，它是过度与亏缺之间的媒介。

210: The amalgamation of knowledge and wisdom of every 6 since the inception of Apeiron will, without any arduous drilling, enter your mind the moment you receive your number. You will make a great leap.
210：每一个 6 的智慧，从阿派朗存在至今的知识之合，无需任何艰苦卓绝的钻研，在你获得数字那一刻便能进入你的脑海——你将完成一次飞跃。

Atticus: ... Do you think I need you to explain the concept to me?
亚齐：……你觉得，我需要你来向我解释“启示”的概念?

210: Oh, it certainly felt like it.
210：噢，原来不用吗?

I snort out a laugh like a true victor.
我嗤笑出声，如同一个真正的胜利者。

Atticus is different today. His usual evasiveness is gone—replaced by anxiety.
他今日不同往常，常常伴随在亚齐身边的那份逃避感不见了——它被一种莫名的焦虑取代。

This suits me. I try to seize on that gap, like prying open an oyster to expose its insides to the sea air.
这正合我意，我试图抓住那个缝隙，像打开牡蛎一般将其剖开，让内里样子暴露在海风里。

Now, looking back at that moment, I can't deny that I lost control.
事到如今，再一次回望那段时刻，我无法否认我的失控。

But it wasn't a day to be defeated, least of all by him.
但这不是一个该被打扰的日子，至少不该是由他打扰。

210: So, should I point out your attitude towards 6?
210：那这条呢，我需要指出——你对待 6 的姿态的错误吗?

210: She's weaker than before. You shouldn't treat her like this.
210：她的身体不如往日，你不该如此对待她。

Atticus: Cut out your d**n rhetoric. What are you trying to say?
亚齐：别再用那些该死的修辞了，你到底想表达什么?

Hear that? The oyster shell has cracked.
听，牡蛎的壳发出了撕裂的脆响。

What a great day to be favored by the truth. This is simply too easy.
今天真是个被真理眷顾的好日子——这太轻松了。

210: Your disrespect towards her ...
210：你对待她如此无礼……

210: She is a 6, one who possesses wisdom, balance, and wholeness. As a fine leader, she manages everything on the island with great efficiency.
210：她是 6，拥有智慧，掌握平衡，涉足圆满。她是优秀的领导者，她将岛屿上的一切处理得井井有条。

210: She cares for the children, connects with the public, and treats you as her own. She has taken on all the duties of your late mother.
210：她爱护孩子，亲和群众，她对你视如己出，几乎承担起了母亲所有的职责。

210: She is intelligent, courageous, and shares willingly with everyone.
210：她聪慧，且乐于分享，充满勇气……

210: She's a role model for 6s; as for you, Atticus—
210：她是 6 的榜样，而你，亚齐——

210: You don't deserve the "revelation". You lack the willingness to share knowledge and the talent to lead, and you haven't and you won't fulfill your obligations.
210：你根本不配拥有“启示”——你没有分享知识的意愿，缺乏让众人追随的才能，不尽一个人应尽的义务。

210: You cannot bear this blessing. You are unworthy of it.
210：你无法承载这份祝福，你受之有愧。

Atticus: ...
亚齐：……

He suddenly falls silent.
他突如其来地安静了。

Atticus: So you think the "revelation" is a blessing?
亚齐：你觉得，“启示”是祝福?

210: ... ?
210：……?

I didn't expect him to focus his sights on a mere turn of phrase.
我没想到他会将重点聚焦在并不重要的地方。

210: Of course—we seek the truth, and the truth lies in wisdom. It's not just me; all the brothers and sisters of Apeiron think like this!
210：当然——我们追寻真理，而真理蕴含于智慧。不仅是我，阿派朗的兄弟姊妹都如此认为！

210: That's why we respect 6—
210：我们也因此尊重着 6——

He remains standing upright, but I notice his shoulders drooping slightly ... as if some invisible weight presses upon them.
他仍是笔直地站立着，但我总觉得，他的肩膀微微塌了下来……像是有什么无形的重物压在那里。

Atticus: The revelation is a curse, my friend.
亚齐：那是诅咒，我的朋友。

Aziz hangs his head, I almost read it like nodding, as if he's nodding to himself.
亚齐否认了我的观点，却点了点头。

This isn't what I want at all. My oyster has shriveled into a pebble.
这并不让我喜悦，我感到牡蛎变为了一块卵石。

Atticus: You're right.
亚齐：你是对的。

Atticus: She's perfect, she's 6.
亚齐：她是完美的，她是一个 6。

Atticus: A complete number, a perfect person, and an outstanding leader.
亚齐：一个完满的数字、一个完美的人、一位出色的领导者。

Atticus: 6s are always like that.
亚齐：6 总是这样的。

He turns away, sidestepping my obstructing arm, and walks towards the exit, where light streams from beyond the grapevine arbor.
他侧过身，从阻拦的手臂旁绕过，走向葡萄藤架外透着光的出口。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

一次证明
A Demonstration COL-307904

A Demonstration
一次证明

Thirty-seven: Ha-ha~
37：哼哼～

Thirty-seven: This new dish tastes wonderful. Why has no one thought of putting fruit in sour yogurt before?
37：这种新菜的味道真好，为什么从前没有人想过把水果放进酸乳酪里呢?

Sophia: I'm glad you like it. I learned the combination before coming to this island.
苏菲亚：你喜欢这种口味就好，我也是从前还在岛外时从别人那儿听说了这种吃法。

Thirty-seven: If you ask me, the flavor tastes just like 143.
37：如果要我说，这种口味尝起来就像是 143。

Thirty-seven: 11 and 13 are both good numbers, and together they factor into another excellent number!
37：11 和 13，两个很好的数字，乘出了一个很好的数字！

It was an ordinary day in all respects. Sophia and I grabbed some food and lounged by the gazebo in the square.
那是很平常的一天，我与苏菲亚拿了一些餐食，在广场的凉亭里休憩。

210: Nice, another compliment true to your style.
210：很好，又是一句符合个人风格的称赞。

Thirty-seven: Oh—I didn't realize you were here too.
37：哦——原来你也在啊。

Of course, so did 210.
当然。还有 210。

Thirty-seven: Keep your head down, 210.
37：低下头来，210。

210: Please, this is hardly an appropriate time, 37.
210：别，现在不是一个合适的时候，37。

210: ...
210：……

Although I think the number 210 is significantly overestimated by the public, I wouldn't hate a walking grapevine stand.
虽然 210 这个数字被显著地高估了——
但是很少有人会痛恨一台移动的葡萄藤架。

Thirty-seven: Heh heh. It's been a while since I ate the grapes on your head. They're still so sweet.
37：嗯，即使很久没吃你头上的葡萄了，它们依然这么甜。

Thirty-seven: I'm thinking of grabbing a few more to try them in this yogurt—
37：或许我可以再拿一些，把它们泡进酸乳酪里——

210: Please, 37, we're not kids anymore.
210：我们已经不是小孩子了，37。

210: No more leaping up to snatch grapes from my head like old times! It's undignified!
210：你不能再……和小时候一样，跳起来摘我头上的葡萄吃了！

Thirty-seven: Oh, don't be like that.
37：别这么说。

I like grapes and other fruits. I like their blend of tart and sweet flavors.
我喜欢葡萄，也喜欢其他水果，它们在我口中释放酸味与甜味。

Thirty-seven: Carrying around grapes is one of your few endearing qualities. Don't downplay it.
37：随身携带着葡萄是你少有的透彻优点，你不能埋没它。

Sophia: ... Ha-ha.
苏菲亚：……呵呵。

Thirty-seven: Sophia? Why are you smiling?
37：苏菲亚？你在笑什么呀？

Sophia: Oh, nothing, just feeling nostalgic. It's been ages since we've all been together for a meal like this. It reminds me of when we were younger.
苏菲亚：没什么，我只是觉得有点开心，因为我们很久没有一起吃饭了，这样让我想起小时候……

Sophia: Back then, we had fewer responsibilities and more time to just be together.
苏菲亚：那个时候，我们身上的工作还少，闲暇时间很多。

Sophia: We'd meet up for meals now and then and even head to the beach for some fun.
苏菲亚：我们偶尔会凑在一起吃饭，有空的时候也会去沙滩上玩耍。

210: As I recall it was that gift that first brought the four of us together.
210：我们四个第一次凑在一起，还是为了一份礼物。

Sophia: Right, the gift I gave to Atticus.
苏菲亚：是的，没错，为了我送给亚齐的礼物。

Sophia: I was new to the island then, and Atticus had been so helpful to me. So, I decided to make him a hat out of Anatolian fabric.
苏菲亚：当时我刚到达岛屿没多久，亚齐帮了我很多忙，所以我就想着，送给他一条安纳托利亚织物制作的帽子。

210: "It's because his hair has gotten so long, always falling over his eyes and getting in the way of his reading."
210：“因为他的头发开始长长了，总是挡住眼睛，看不清书本。”

210: Our Star of Hermes gave us a great suggestion.
210：我们的赫尔墨斯之星给出了很好的建议。

It's only when we look back that we realize how far we've come.
人总是在回望的时候才注意到自己已经走了多远。

Talking about the past brings us some joy.
谈论过去让我们找到一些乐趣。

Thirty-seven: A scarf or hat is too plain, it fades over time and lacks geometric beauty—
37：头巾或是帽子太普通了，它会随着时间褪色，也缺少几何的美感——

Thirty-seven: We should give him a diadem headpiece, a sturdy and slender one. That way, it won't be too hot in the summer or get damp in the rainy season.
37：我们应该送他一枚头饰，坚硬的、纤细的头饰，这样夏天也不至于闷热，雨季也不至于潮湿。

Stretching out my hands, I make a fitting triangular shape with the index fingers and thumbs of both hands.
伸出手来，用左右两只手的食指与拇指比划一个漂亮的锥。

Thirty-seven: And equilateral triangles are the best shape! It would make a unique gift!
37：而等边三角形是最好的形状！这会是一份很别致的礼物！

Thirty-seven: It's just a pity ... that the plan fell through ...
37：只可惜……这个计划泡汤了……

210: That's why I always say Atticus should thank me.
210：所以我常说，亚齐应该感谢我。

210 has begun to eat the grapes draping from his head as well, a sure sign that he's beginning to relax.
210 也开始食用头上的葡萄了，这是他精神开始放松的体现。

210: It was me who met you in front of the blacksmith's shop and reshaped the crown into a more angular circle.
210：是我在铁匠铺前遇到你们，将那顶头冠的形状修整为了略带棱角的圆。

210: Otherwise, he'd always hurt himself when he bumped into things.
210：不然他总会磕碰，而后因为那些东西受伤——

Thirty-seven: No, not at all.
37：不，才不是。

Thirty-seven: Comfort is pointless. The essential beauty of mathematics is far more important, like the clothes we wear!
37：舒适是无用的，合乎本质的数学之美才是更重要的，就像是我们的衣裳！

Sophia: Regardless, he accepted my gift, and the crown indeed helped keep his hair in place.
苏菲亚：无论如何，他接受了我的礼物，那顶头冠也的确帮助他固定了头发。

Sophia: Maybe I can volunteer to deliver Atticus's meal today, bring him some fruit and yogurt, and have a chat with him.
苏菲亚：也许我可以申请今天为亚齐送餐的工作，把水果和酸乳酪带给他，并且与他聊聊天……

Thirty-seven: Not today.
37：今天不行。

After finishing my fruit and yogurt, I have other things I must do.
我吃完了那份酸乳酪配水果，我还有事要做。

I have planned it all out and set the time earlier.
我已经计划好了这件事，早早地确定好了时候。

Thirty-seven: That task has already been assigned to me today.
37：今天那份工作已经交给我了。

This is my first time on meal delivery duty.
这是我第一次担任送饭的职务。

Most of the time, I'm preoccupied with much more demanding tasks. It required me to spend some time explaining my reasons.
大部分时候，我都有更重要也更需要我负责的工作要做。所以，在我接手这份工作之前，我花费了一些时间去解释其中缘由。

Thirty-seven: 6!
37： 6！

Atticus: 37 ... ?
亚齐： 37……?

He must be surprised by my arrival.
他对我的到来很意外。

As surprised as when he first heard me call him 6 instead of Atticus.
就像是第一次听到我称呼他为 6，而不是亚齐一样意外。

Thirty-seven: I have something I want to talk to you about; you can eat while listening.
37： 我有些事儿想和你聊聊，你可以边吃饭边听我说。

I cross the porch and then stoop to pass through the low inner door.
我穿过门廊，又俯下身子走过矮矮的里门。

His retreat room is dim, cramped, and completely windowless. The floor is littered with books, some open, some closed.
闭关小屋内昏暗而狭窄，没有一扇窗户。地板上堆满了书籍，有的翻开，有的合起。

Placing the meal on the small table, I sit down across from Atticus.
将餐盘放在小桌上，我坐在亚齐面前的另一侧。

Thirty-seven: This is fruit with sour yogurt, a combination Sophia learned from the outside. It tastes very much like 143, in the best way.
37： 啊——对了，这是水果搭配酸乳酪，苏菲亚从外面见识到的吃法，尝起来味道不差。

Atticus: ... Thank you.
亚齐： ……谢谢。

I scan the book 6 is reading; Euclid's "Elements", nothing more than a basic primer in our school.
亚齐在读一本《几何原本》，最基础的读物。

A small hill of books lies beside him, their edges showing signs of having been turned. He must have read them all.
而更多书摆在他身边，几乎垒成小山，书的边沿有着翻动的痕迹，他已经把它们都读了一个遍。

Atticus: But why are you here? It's not your job to deliver meals to those in retreat.
亚齐： 但你为什么会在这里，为闭关者送饭并不是你的工作。

Atticus: Is there something you need from me?
亚齐： 你有事要找我吗?

He ponders, and seems to answer his own question wordlessly.
他思考，很快自问自答。

He seems different from usual.
我感觉他看上去不太一样了。

Thirty-seven: I'm not good at debates outside of proofs, but you've always been so smart and precise. 210's reasoning is too absurd and flowery, and Sophia's answers feel too mild.
37： 我不擅长证明之外的辩论，但你总是聪明而精准的。210 的道理太过荒谬，苏菲亚的答案又太温和。

Thirty-seven: 6 is just right to answer such questions. The bigger 6 lacks spare time, always talking about the ship, too busy to even stop for a moment.
37： 6 正适宜为我解答这样的问题，而大一些的那个 6 欠缺空余，他们在说船的事儿，忙得脚不沾地。

Thirty-seven: So, I came to you—the smaller 6, as opposed to the bigger 6.
37： 所以，我来找你了——相较于大一些的 6，更小一些的 6。

Atticus seems to have finally gotten used to me calling him 6.
亚齐已经习惯了我称呼他为 6，这很好。

But many people on the island still call him Atticus. They say there can't be two 6s on the island at the same time.
但岛上的人仍旧称呼他为亚齐，他们说，岛上不能同时有两个 6。

Atticus: She will make time for you. She values you all ... and she is better at exploring these kinds of issues.
亚齐：她会为你腾出时间的，她很看重你们，也更善于探讨问题。

Thirty-seven: You're just not one for talking, it's not that you're bad at thinking.
37：你只是不爱说话，不是不擅长思考。

Atticus: She is the current 6.
亚齐：她才是现在的 6。

Thirty-seven: It makes no difference to me. She is a 6, and so are you. You are the same in essence.
37：这没什么差别，她是 6，你也是 6。你们的本质相同。

My questions are ready, but the path forward isn't smooth. This is a common occurrence in calculations, but I won't be discouraged by it.
我的问题已经准备好了，行进的路却不顺畅，这是演算中常有的事，我不会为此气馁。

If one path is blocked, take a detour; if all paths are blocked, climb through the bushes.
如果一条路堵上了，就绕一条路，如果所有路都堵上了，就爬过灌木丛。

Bushes and walls of books aren't all that different; I know how to climb past them to reach my destination.
灌木丛和书本组成的墙壁差距不大，我知道如何爬过它们，到达我的目的地。

Thirty-seven: 26 thinks I shouldn't overlook the process of proof.
37：26 认为我不应忽略掉证明的过程。

Thirty-seven: I know that. My mother taught me the same. Steps should be imprinted on paper and actualized to give more meaning to the results.
37：这我知道，妈妈也是这样教导我的——步骤应烙印纸上，落在实处，才能赋予结果更多的意义。

Thirty-seven: But 26 believes that even proof leading to a wrong result should be documented. To me that seems ... inexplicable!
37：可是 26 认为，即使是最终结果是错误的证明，也应当留下过程。这完全是莫名其妙！

Thirty-seven: Everyone knows that the result of a proof is what matters most. A proof that's wrong shouldn't even exist from the start. Like your "Elements," it wouldn't include false theorems.
37：大家都知道，证明的结果是最重要的。一个证明如果错误，那它从一开始就不应该存在。就像你手里的《几何原本》，它不会收录错误的定理。

Thirty-seven: I think he's wasting time. Focusing on such trivialities only distracts from our judgment of true essence.
37：我认为他是在白费力气。强调这种没有意义的琐事，只会干扰大家对本质的判断。

Thirty-seven: But I can't decide whether I am right or wrong. I need your help.
37：但我无法决定对错，我需要你的帮助。

He closes "Elements" and turns towards me.
他合上《几何原本》，将身体转向我。

I suddenly realize it's been a long time since we last met. His blue eyes are becoming more like those of 6. Yes, as they should. 6s are the same in essence.
我突然意识到我们真的有许久未见了。那双蓝色的眼睛越来越像 6，啊，是的，这是应当的，正如我所说，6 本质如一。

Atticus: You mean 26, the sincere man who, in his youth, led the children of Apeiron in their training, including you and me.
亚齐：我记得 26，他是个诚恳的人，在幼年时期，曾领着阿派朗的孩童们修行——其中也包括你我。

Atticus: 37, why do you need to know the right or wrong in this?
亚齐：37，你为何需要这个对错呢?

Thirty-seven: What kind of question is that? Everything ought to have an answer; I just want to know it! That's all.
37：这算是什么问题？一切都应有答案，我想知道答案！仅此而已。

He smiles and shakes his head.
他微笑着摇了摇头。

Atticus: Words kill the essence. I think 26 just wanted to keep a record of your trials and errors to inform future seekers. He's always valued the passing down of knowledge, and you were always the trailblazer.
亚齐：言语会消磨本质，我想，26 只是想要留下你的试错记录来告知后来的探寻者。他历来注重知识的传承，而你总是走在最前面的那个。

Atticus: He's sincere but also clumsy. He probably quickly forgot his original purpose when it came to you.
亚齐：他诚恳，但也笨拙，面对你——他可能很快就忘了自己原本寻求的目的。

Atticus: Perhaps you both lost sight of each other's motives in the argument. Did you quarrel?
亚齐：或许你们在争论中都忽略了对方的动机——你们吵架了吗?

Thirty-seven: ... Hmm.
37：……唔。

6 is right. It wasn't a pleasant debate between 26 and me. Since Sophia's arrival, I've not seen anyone give me that kind of look.
他猜得不错，那不是一次愉快的论证。在苏菲亚到来之后，我已经很久没有再看到其他人对我露出那样的目光了。

Thirty-seven: Alright, I understand about 26's mindset. But I still want to know, is there any value in a proof with a conclusion that turns out to be wrong?
37：好的，有关 26 的事情我明白了。但我仍想知道，最终结果为错误的证明，有存在的价值吗?

Occasionally, such questions would cause 6 to ponder briefly, but now, his response is swift.
偶尔，这样的问题偶尔会让 6 陷入短暂的沉思，但现在，他的回答却如此迅速。

Looks like I'm in luck.
看来我运气不错。

Atticus: 37, value is relative.
亚齐：37，价值是相对的。

Thirty-seven: Well it shouldn't be! People ought to only value a proof because it's correct!
37：不应当。人们之所以会记住一个证明，是因为它是正确的!

Thirty-seven: If there's no measure for judgment, why do we distinguish right from wrong at all?
37：如果没有一个判断的尺度的话，我们为何要分出对错呢?

Atticus: ...
亚齐：……

I actually don't care about the answer to this question. It's irrelevant to mathematics.
我其实不在乎这个问题的答案，它与数学无关。

But debates over definitions are always my weakness. Though I'm convinced that I'm right, I fail to convince others.
但这些关乎名词定义的辩论总是我的弱势。我知道我是正确的，可我无法说服别人。

Numbers are solid and reliable, while language is vague and unclear. People argue endlessly over rhetoric and semantics, shifting focus away from the essence of things.
数字坚实可靠，语言却模糊不清。人们没完没了地为修辞争吵，把目光从本质上移开。

6 is the best of us at these questions. He always finds a fable that makes things simple and understandable.
6 是我们中最擅长这些问题的人，他总是会说一个寓言，把事情讲得简单而明白。

I wait for 6 to tell me a fable so that the next time I get into a debate, I can come up with a perfect example.
我等待着 6 告诉我一个故事。这样下次我再遇到辩论时，就可以举出一个绝妙的例子。

Atticus: I'm sorry, 37 ...
亚齐：很抱歉，37……

Atticus: I can't help you with that right now.
亚齐：我暂时没有办法帮助你解决这个问题。

6 shifts his gaze away, turns a page, and adjusts the angle of the crown pressing on his head.
6 移开了目光，他翻开一页书，调整了头冠压在上面的角度。

It looks like it would make a fine paperweight—the metallic triangle is certainly more ideal than fabric in that role.
看来它是个很不错的压书工具——三角形就是比织物更加完美。

Thirty-seven: I can wait for you to finish your page.
37：我可以等你读完这页书。

Atticus: No ... it's not about the page. I truly don't know how to answer your question.
亚齐：不……它和这页书无关。我确实不知道如何回答你的问题。

Atticus: Or maybe I'm searching for that answer too.
亚齐：或者说，我也在寻找这个答案。

I watch him close the book, sliding it back into the mountain of others.
我看着他合上书本，插入小山一般的书堆中。

Thirty-seven: So when you're done reading all these books, will you have the answer?
37：好吧……那等你看完这些书，你就有答案了吗?

Atticus: ...
亚齐：……

Atticus: I don't know.
亚齐：我也不知道。

Atticus: But it's better to try something than to do nothing at all.
亚齐：但是做些尝试，总比什么都不做来得更好。

Thirty-seven: Hmm ... ?
37：唔……?

That doesn't sound like his usual style. And I feel like I've heard it somewhere else.
这句话并不像是他往日的风格。而且，我总觉得在其它地方听到过。

He really has changed. It's strange; can appearances change so noticeably while the essence remains the same?
他确实变得和以前不一样了。这很奇妙，本质不变的情况下，现象变化会如此明显吗?

There must be a key to this.
这中间一定是有什么关键。

Thirty-seven: So ... Is this a proof you have to give?
37: 所以，你是在做一个证明吗?

Thirty-seven: One that requires a room full of books and a long retreat—the ultimate proof?
37: 要动用一屋子的书和漫长的闭关来完成的，一个究极的证明?

Thirty-seven: Then you should've told me earlier. I don't want to be taken by Abraxas, and be tied to a rock to have my eyes pecked out by vultures!
37: 那你应该早点告诉我的，我可不想被阿其翁抓到岩壁上，叫秃鹰啄食眼睛!

Atticus: ...
亚齐: ……

Atticus: No, it's not that serious. I'm just contemplating the nature of "6".
亚齐: 不，没有那么严重。我只是在思考“6”的事。

Atticus: ... Maybe this is indeed a proof, one about my own number.
亚齐: ……或许这的确是我关于自己数字的证明。

Thirty-seven: Hm? But you already know the answer. What's there left to prove?
37: 唔？可你已经知道答案了。这还有什么需要证明的吗?

6's answer seems to wait on a breath. He flips through the book with a faint smile.
6 的尾音无奈地下垂。他带着一丝笑意，翻动手中的书页。

Atticus: ... In that lies a whole other question entirely, 37.
亚齐: ……这就是另一个问题了，37。

Atticus: Does a proof with a correct conclusion have any value?
亚齐: 最终结果为正确的证明，有存在的价值吗?

In that single phrase 6 has utterly bewildered me.
我完全不明白 6 的意思。

I am 37, he is 6, right from birth. Neither of us ever proved our numbers, but we simply know the answer to be right.
我是 37，他是 6，一出生就是了。我们都没有证明过自己的数字，但我们都知道这个答案是正确的。

It's enough; the essence cannot change. So why would 6 ask such a question?
这便够了，本质不会改变。那 6 为什么要这么询问呢?

It's a needless worry, a waste of effort.
这只是庸人自扰，白费力气。

But I suddenly feel I shouldn't disturb him anymore.
但我不再适合打扰他了。

The work of a proof mustn't be interrupted or hindered; that's a rule everyone knows.
证明是不可被打断与阻碍的，这是人人都知道的规矩。

He escorts me to the door of his retreat room, and I stoop again to pass through the low inner door.
他将我送到闭关小屋的门口，我又一次弯着腰走过低矮的内门。

This door, obstructing vision as well as movement, makes it feel more like a cave than a doorway. It makes the retreat seem even more sealed off.
这门阻碍视野，也阻碍行动，比起门扉，更像洞穴。它让闭关来得更加彻底。

Thirty-seven: Hey—okay, I'm out!
37：嘿——好了，我出来了！

I can't clearly recall how I bid farewell to 6 or whether he cautioned me to watch my step. I know I didn't get a straight answer from him; only another question was tacked on—one that left me confused and a little dizzy.
我已经记不清楚我如何与 6 告别，他又是否嘱咐了我行走时留心脚下。我没有在他这里得到答案，反而被多加了一个问题。这让我迷惑不解，头脑发晕。

Fortunately, just as I leave the cave and feel the night sea breeze, a solution that I had disregarded earlier comes back to me. A perfectly timed epiphany.
好在，就在我离开洞穴、吹拂夜晚的海风时，一个早先搁置的命题解法在我脑海中清明呈现。那是恰到好处的灵光一闪。

I hurry home to write it down.
我急匆匆地返回家中，将其记录。

On the way, I cross paths with Sophia again, she expresses some concern for 6 and asks me about him.
在路上，我遇到了苏菲亚，她关切 6 的情况，对我询问。

Does he read a lot? Is he still in good health? Is he working on a proof? What kind of proof is it?
他读了许多书吗？他身体还健康吗？他在证明？那是什么样的证明？

He's read many books, as many as a small mountain.
他读了许多书，多得像是一座小山。

His health is fine. He eats well and breathes evenly.
他的身体健康无碍，进食顺畅，呼吸匀称。

I know nothing of his proof—but in any case, it seems to be a proof about himself.
他的证明我一无所知——但无论如何，那总归是一个有关于他自己的证明。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

童话书
The Book for Children COL-307905

The Book for Children
童话书

Proof requires time.
证明是需要时间的。

Atticus still hasn't fully gotten his own answer.
亚齐仍未彻底地得到属于自己的答案。

Atticus: "A voice from the above spoke to a man, 'An important thing will happen to you.'"
亚齐：天上的声音如是说，有件大事将要发生在你身上……

Outside his retreat room, people are chopping down trees from the forest, slicing the wood into planks, and then fashioning sticks and joints from the planks.
从林中砍伐树木，又从树木中裁切木板，再从木板中刨拨木棍与卯口。

The outline of the ship has already taken shape.
船的轮廓便已存在了。

Atticus: Thus, he spends his life waiting for a miracle.
亚齐：于是，他终其一生地等待一个奇迹。

Atticus: Until death arrives, and nothing has happened.
亚齐：直至死亡到来，一切仍未发生。

A ship signifies the start of a journey. It carries people and goods across waters ... it discovers new worlds.
船意味着旅途的开始，它能够承载人与货物，跨越水域，遇见新世界。

People call out, communicating with one another, choosing a direction.
人们呼喊着，互相沟通，选定了方向。

Atticus: "When the man lay sick in bed, he cried up to the voice from above, asking, 'When will all that you have promised finally arrive?'"
亚齐：那人缠绵病榻时，又对天上的声音询问，那件大事在何时发生?

Pushing, pushing, and then more pushing. Clear grooves are left in the sand.
推动，推动，紧接着推动。沙地上留下清晰的沟壑。

Atticus: ...
亚齐：……

Atticus: Please come in.
亚齐：请进来吧。

A figure appears at the entrance of the retreat room. He walks over to the desk and places down a dinner tray, but does not sit down.
闭关处的门口出现一道身影，他走进桌案，放下餐盘，却不就坐。

210: It's strange that you actually feel like talking.
210：真稀奇，你居然有兴致与人聊天。

They are not on friendly terms, with 210's attitude resembling a bristled tomcat.
他们的关系不友好，210 的态度如同炸开了背毛的雄猫。

Atticus lowers his head and flips through the pages, then uses his crown to hold down the book before looking up at him.
亚齐低下头，翻动书页，又用头冠压住书本，才抬起头来看向他。

Atticus: This has nothing to do with my personal feelings. You must have something to say since you came here specifically.
亚齐：这与我的主观意识无关。和 37 一样，你特地前来，一定是有话要说。

Atticus: That being the case, you might as well just ask.
亚齐：既然确定如此，直接询问更为快捷。

210: The ship has already set sail.
210：船已经起航了。

210: Many people are on that ship, people we know, people who watched us grow up.
210：很多人都在那艘船上，我们熟悉的人，看着我们长大的人。

210: The cook, the accountant, the errata operator ... Sophia's father, and 6 ... they're all on the ship.
210：负责烹饪食物的人，负责精算的人，负责勘误的人……苏菲亚的父亲，与 6……他们都在船上。

For a small island that has so far managed to avoid the Emanation, exploring into the storm undoubtedly requires immense courage.
对于一座得以避免“流溢”的小岛来说，向雨幕的探索无疑聚集着数之不尽的勇气。

This is destined to be a great journey where people confirm and reconfirm their hypotheses, staking their lives for the opportunity to discover new horizons and search for the truth.
这注定是一场伟大的旅行，人们确认，再确认，以生命作为抵押才能坐上拓展眼界与寻觅真理的桌案。

Atticus: Sophia already told me that the ship was completed.
亚齐：苏菲亚已经对我说过，他们的船竣工了。

The windowless and narrow-doored retreat is cut off from the outside world. And it seems this fervent exploration movement hasn't affected any of Atticus's plans.
无窗且窄门的闭关处与外界隔绝，热火朝天的探索运动并未波及亚齐的计划。

He never stepped out to see the new beginnings, as if the island's achievements had nothing to do with him.
他不曾出门观看新生的一切，就好像这座岛的壮举与他毫无干系。

Piles of books have been shifted around, spreading outward, while new books are placed closer to his inner circle, like ripples from a droplet of water on the surface of a lake.
成堆的书本被挪动了位置，向着外层扩散，而接近他的内圈又摆放上了新的书籍，如同一滴水落下后，水面鼓起的涟漪。

210: Aren't you going to see them off?
210：你不打算去送行吗?

Atticus: I am still in retreat.
亚齐：我尚在闭关中。

210: You never intend to fulfill your duties.
210：你从不打算履行自己的义务。

210: Perhaps it's the predetermination of fate that sets you apart, or maybe it's the brilliance of another 6 that makes you feel so inferior.
210：或许是那既定的命运让你从此与众不同了，也或许，是另一位 6 的光芒使你自惭形秽。

The accumulated resentment between them further sharpens his words.
积怨使话语变得锋利。

The young man has followed his aspirations, which developed reverence, and then he comes into contact with envy – resignation, suspicion, and resentment.
年轻的人跟随憧憬，产生崇敬，而后，他开始接触妒忌——不甘、怀疑与怨怼。

He starts to question himself and, silently, fate itself.
他开始质问自己，也无声地质问命运。

210: I can't help but wonder if you are truly capable of doing the job of a 6.
210：我不免怀疑，你是否真的能做好 6 的工作。

Atticus: Your respect for 6 ... I mean Alma, has blinded you.
亚齐：你对 6……我是指艾尔玛，你对她的尊敬蒙蔽了你。

Atticus: Your questioning doesn't come from the heart. Emotions are clouding your judgment.
亚齐：你并非出自本心提出质疑，你的心里有情感，它们蒙蔽了你的判断。

The pages of the book turn to a new chapter, and a familiar fable jumps out—
书页又翻新章节，熟悉的故事跃然眼前。

Atticus: 6 is only a number.
亚齐：6 只是 6，一个数字。

Atticus: You should listen more to what 37 says, "the number is significantly overestimated by the public."
亚齐：你应该多听听 37 所说的话。它被世人严重地高估了。

—A fable that tells a familiar story. This is the third time Atticus has read it today.
一篇寓言，讲述着熟悉的故事。
这是亚齐今天第三次读到它。

Atticus: ... This topic should end now. You've delivered your message; now we should get back to our respective work.
亚齐：……这个话题应该结束了，你想传达的信息已经带到，我们应该回到各自的工作中去了。

Atticus: "Go back, 210. I don't want to argue with you."
亚齐：回去吧，210。我不想与你争论。

That crown of his is infuriating.
那个金色的头顶让人恼火。

210: My friend, what book are you reading? What kind of work has touched your heart, making you so obsessed with it that you neglect friends and family?
210：我的朋友，你在看什么书？是什么样的著作拨动了您的心弦，让您沉湎其中，以至于忽略掉美好的亲情？

His actions contradict his modest tone. He reaches out and decisively pulls out the book that has been the subject of this undue attention.
动作与谦逊的语气背道而驰，他伸手，果决地抽出了那本被过分关注的书。

210's breathing becomes deep and slow, his heart bubbling like a flatbread on a stove.
210 的呼吸变得深而慢，他的心如同放在炉子上的饼。

It's a picture book, The Voice From Above. It's so familiar, so ordinary. Every child on the island has heard this story at some point or another.
那是一册绘本。《来自于天上的声音》，它如此令人感到熟悉，如此普遍。岛屿上的每个孩子都曾听过这个故事。

210: Is this what you've been busy with ... reading these, these children's books?
210：这就是你在忙的事……就是看这些、这些孩子所看的书？

Atticus: Not only those, but indeed them as well.
亚齐：不止于此，但确实包括它。

Atticus speaks calmly, as if stating something that is a matter of course.
亚齐语气平静，像在阐述一件理所当然的事。

210: A ... children's fable ... ?
210：一本……儿童寓言……？

In anger, 210 leans forward, clenches his fist, and presses it on the table.
出于愤怒，青年人向前倾斜身体，手掌握拳，压在桌面上。

210: It seems the "curse" of being 6 has driven you mad. The wisdom and talent destined for you have given you the audacity to squander them.
210：看来 6 的使命真的让你发了疯，注定降临的智慧与才能给了你挥霍的勇气……

210: Yet, no matter what, you will become a 6, and you will receive all the gifts that come with that crown!
210：是啊，无论如何，你终究会成为 6 的，终究会获得那顶桂冠上的一切馈赠！

210: You value your kin less than a children's fable. You see your friendly neighbors as vague "others" ...
210：你将你的亲人看得不如一本儿童寓言，你将你的友邻视为模糊的他者……

210: A blessing bestowed upon the least deserving person—
210：一份祝福，降临在了最不该领取它的人身上——

210's voice chokes in his throat, then, with a snort, sizzles out like a flame in water.
210 的声音哽在喉头，紧接着，如同被迎面泼下一盆水的火焰似的，嗤的一声黯淡下去。

210: Your head lacks wisdom, and your heart lacks compassion.
210：你的心中并无智慧，脑中更无关爱。

He stands straight, palms covering his eyes, hiding his expression.
他直起身子，用手掌挡住双眼，遮盖自己的表情。

210: I can see that you'll be the reason why we stagnate in seeking the truth!
210：……我可以预见，你只会让学派探寻的智慧停滞不前！

Atticus: Progress is relative.
亚齐：进步是相对的。

Atticus lifts his head from the book, and his blue eyes are widened.
亚齐从书本之中抬起头，也抬起一双蓝色的眼睛。

Atticus: Is it then? Well, let me ask you, my friend. If the wisdom we seek leads us to our own destruction, what would you choose?
亚齐：那么我请问你，朋友。如果我们追求的智慧，会造成我们自身的覆灭，你又会如何选择?

210: ... What do you mean?
210：……你这是什么意思?

210: Are you suggesting that our decision to explore beyond the island is wrong?!
210：你在暗示我们向岛外探寻的决策是错误的吗?!

Atticus: I didn't mean that ...
亚齐：我并没有那个意思……

The misalignment in the conversation leads to misunderstanding, and 210's anger almost becomes tangible and touchable.
对话的错位造成了误解，210 身上的怒气几乎变得有形且可触碰。

Atticus: I'm just thinking ... no, forget I said anything.
亚齐：我只是在思考……不，就当我什么都没说过吧。

Their resentment towards one another boils past reconciliation.
怨恨已经无可弥合。

210: ... Fine, stick to your perspective then.
210：……很好，保持着你的观点吧。

210's departing footsteps intermingle with Atticus's calm narration, eventually merging into the sound of the wooden door slamming shut.
210 离去的脚步声与亚齐平静的叙述相互交杂，最终，一起落入猛地摔上木门的响声中。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

有顶之屋
A House, a Shelter COL-307906

A House, a Shelter
有顶之屋

After 210 left in anger, I heard the shouts of people as the ship set sail.
210 愤怒地离开之后，我听见船起航时人们呼喊的声音。

This debate wasn't planned; it inevitably disrupted the balance, like dropping a pinch of dust on one side of the scale.
这场争辩并不在计划之中，它不可避免地打乱了平衡，在天秤的一侧落下一捧灰尘。

Each pinch wasn't very heavy. Even a breath could blow it away. But bit by bit, they still made their impact.
它们并不沉重，甚至只一呼就可吹飞，但它们依旧造成了影响。

And the balance began to tilt.
平衡开始倾斜。

Atticus: ...
亚齐：……

Atticus: ... The retreat is no place for such arguments. From now on, I should not engage in casual conversations.
亚齐：……闭关处不该是争吵的地方，从此以后，不应该轻易地与人交谈。

I am not fond of talking. Silence is a virtue adhered to by many members of the school.
我并不喜欢说话。保持缄默，是学派成员恪守的美德。

But in prolonged solitude, I learned to converse with myself.
但在漫长的独处中，我学会了和自己交谈。

Language, when devoid of other listeners, diminishes in impact but accelerates self-reflection.
语言在没有倾听者时，便会减少影响，而增加自我梳理的进度。

Atticus: I've finished these books. Later, I'll tell the coordinator about the new book list.
亚齐：这些书已经看完了。晚些的时候，将新的书目告诉协理者。

I reach out, pulling out a new book from the bottom of the pile.
我伸出手，由书堆下层抽取，替换一本新的书。

A scroll, moved by my sleeve, slips from the gap in the book spine and falls to the floor.
一张卷轴被衣袖带动，从书脊的隙缝中滑落至地。

It's a poem I know well, one I used to recite silently during those days of reticence.
这是一首我很熟悉的诗歌，在那些闭口不言的日子，我曾反复默念过上面的字句。

Atticus: ... "The Golden Verses".
亚齐：……《金言》。

Pythagoras' most famous collection of sayings. Its chronicler is unknown, but the content of the verses is timeless.
毕达哥拉斯最著名的言论集。它的记录者已不可考，诗言内容却隽永相传。

Atticus: To think deeply, to restrain oneself, to pursue the treasures of the mind and soul.
亚齐：要认真思考，要克制己身，要追求思想和灵魂的宝藏。

Atticus: To respect the gods and the Supreme, to honor the daemons and inhabitants of the elements, to rise above lower worldly natures.
亚齐：要尊敬诸神和至高的存在，尊重魔鬼和元素中的居民，超越低等的世俗本性。

I first heard this poem from Alma.
我第一次听到这首诗，是从艾尔玛的口中。

At that time, she wasn't yet a 6, and she went by her own name.
那个时候，她还不是 6，在人与人之间行走时，使用着自己的名字。

And I was young, so young that I needed an elder to read me those lengthy verses.
那个时候，我还年幼，年幼到需要一个长辈为我读那些悠长的诗篇。

Atticus: Aunt Alma, I don't understand.
亚齐：艾尔玛姨妈，我不明白。

Atticus: This part here says: "Fate is like a huge millstone on which mortals roll back and forth, enduring endless suffering."
亚齐：这里说道："命运正如一个巨大的磨盘，凡人在其上来回滚动，承受无穷的苦痛。"

Atticus: ... Do we really have to be like this? Is fate such a bad thing?
亚齐：……我们非得这样吗？命运是这么坏的东西吗？

Atticus: Aunt Alma?
亚齐：艾尔玛姨妈？

Alma: Oh ...
艾尔玛：噢……

Alma moves the book away from her face, yawning under the gazebo.
艾尔玛移开脸上的书籍，在凉亭下打了个哈欠。

Alma: ... Why are you not asleep yet?
艾尔玛：……你还没有睡着？

Alma: If you ask me, this weather is just perfect for a nap under the grapevines ...
艾尔玛：要我说，这天气可真是舒服，正适合在葡萄架下打盹……

Alma closes her eyes again, ignoring the verses in my hand.
艾尔玛又合上了眼，对我手里的诗篇置若罔闻。

In reality, she is never good with kids.
实际上，她并不是一个擅长带孩子的人。

She takes care of me in place of my mother. For her, it is just another responsibility she has to undertake.
她代替我的妈妈来照顾我。于她而言，这是一项工作，一份不得不承担的责任。

And my mother has more important matters—the responsibilities of a 6.
而我的母亲有更重要的事务——名为 6 的责任。

One day, that responsibility will also belong to me.
这责任终有一天也会属于我。

Alma: Atticus, why don't you come over here and take a nap?
艾尔玛：亚齐，你为什么不来这边打会儿盹呢？

Alma: Thinking about fate isn't something a child your age should be preoccupied with.
艾尔玛：思考命运可不是你这个年龄的孩子该做的事。

Atticus: But, I want to know—
亚齐：可是，我想要知道——

I am eager to ask my question, but Alma just shakes her head.
我急于征询自己的问题，可艾尔玛只是摇了摇头。

Alma: Oh, yes, you're a good child. You've heard much talk from people about 6, fate, truth, the "revelation," and other such grand topics.
艾尔玛：噢，是的，你是个乖巧的孩子，从人们那里听了太多关于 6，命运、真理、“启示”之类的宏大话。

Alma: But if you stay fixated on these abstract concepts, the happiness that's right in front of you will slip away.
艾尔玛：可总是凝视这些抽象的概念，会让眼前的幸福溜走的。

Alma takes the verses out of my hands and pats me on the back.
艾尔玛抽走了我手里的诗篇，拍了拍我的背。

Alma: Come, Atticus, lie down here. It's a beautiful day, and these grapes are just ripe.
艾尔玛：来，亚齐，躺在这儿。今天是个好天气，这些葡萄也正值成熟。

Alma: I know you're still thinking about the exhortations in "The Golden Verses"—
艾尔玛：我知道你还在想《金言》的劝诫——

Alma: "Very few people know how to escape their own misfortune, for they have not yet seen their own fate."
艾尔玛：“极少有人知道如何摆脱自身的不幸，因为他们尚未看清自己的命运。”

Alma: But this sunlight, the sound of the wind, and these naps are just as much a part of who we are.
艾尔玛：但这些阳光、风声、小憩，同样也是我们自身的一部分。

Alma: Let's lie here together, savoring these rare, precious moments.
艾尔玛：让我们一起躺在这吧，这是难得的好时光。

Alma places "The Golden Verses" on her face and drifts back to sleep.
艾尔玛将《金言》盖在脸上，自顾自地重新睡去。

She has always been a humorous and light-hearted person, standing out like a glass bead among pebbles on this island of strict rules.
她一直是一个幽默而轻松的人，在这个恪守戒律的岛上，就像鹅卵石里的玻璃珠一般突出。

And I am a solitary and precocious child, prematurely subjected to the burdensome weight of responsibility.
而我是一个孤僻且早熟的孩子，过早接受了那些如高山上沉岩一般凝重的训导。

Only around Alma did I feel any relief.
唯有在艾尔玛身边，我感到短暂的轻松。

Atticus: ... Lie down, huh?
亚齐：……躺下，吗?

I hear the birds singing, the wind whispering, the distant sound of waves crashing against the shore.
我听到鸟鸣，风语，远处海浪拍岸的声音。

I have read many profound books, memorized many ancient maxims, and dealt with many complex calculations.
我阅读过许多高深的书目，背诵了许多古老的箴言，接触过许多复杂的计算。

But it was Alma that provided me with "The Golden Verses" with a page filled with bright annotations.
但只有艾尔玛给了《金言》一页落满阳光的注解。

It is a perfect, comfortable warmth, a moment of tranquility that brings no anxiety.
那是一种恰到好处的温暖，一种不会带来任何焦虑的片刻寂静。

Like the waves that occasionally lap my toes at the edge of the island, gently approaching and then retreating, providing a cool sensation that brings joy to a stroll along the beach.
就像海岛边缘时不时扑到我脚尖的浪花，轻轻靠近，慢慢离开，偶尔带来清凉的感觉，足以让沙滩边的漫步变得舒适。

—She was like that.
——她曾是这样的。

So, I leave my sheltered home, tread on the soft sand, and experience the understanding she spoke of.
于是我走出有顶的家，踏入细软的沙地，体会她所言的理解。

Experienced what others call "playtime."
体会其他人称之为“玩闹”的时光。

The sand is moist, the sea breeze is salty, my clothes feel heavy, and my skin is clammy with droplets of moisture.
沙地湿润，海风咸涩，我的衣物变得沉重，皮肤黏腻得凝结出水珠。

The vast sea always by my side, with waves lapping against the shore, yet they never soaked me fully.
巨大的海始终在我身侧，浪潮拍打沙地，却从未真正打湿我的躯体。

有顶之屋
A House, a Shelter COL-307907

Atticus: Alma, I'm back ...
亚齐: 艾尔玛，我回……

I had spent too much time playing.
我在玩闹上花费了太多时间。

So much so that I forgot fate is like a stone rolling down a high mountain, and eventually it rolls over all of us.
以至于忘记了，命运正如高山上的滚石，终有一天会降临在我们身上。

6, the original perfect number, a symbol of completeness and harmony.
6，最初的完全数，完满与和谐的象征。

When it manifests in the soul, the "revelation" from the above is bestowed.
在它显现于灵魂之时，天上的“启示”将加诸于身。

A 6 possesses supreme wisdom, pioneering vision, and just balance. They are perfect in every way, like a beacon leading the faithful forward.
6 会拥有无上的智慧、开拓的眼界、公正的权衡，十全十美，如一盏明灯，带领信仰者前进。

But only afterward did I realize what it truly meant.
但在这之后，我才意识到它真正意味着什么。

Atticus: Alma?
亚齐: 艾尔玛?

She doesn't respond to my call, or stir at all.
她没有回应我的呼唤，也没有回过头来。

Looking back now, my innate sensitivity as a child picked up on those anomalies long before my own wisdom did.
现在回忆起来，孩子天然敏锐的触觉在我的智慧之前发现了那些异常之处。

Atticus: ...
亚齐：……

Suddenly feeling fear, I stop asking questions, merely holding my breath and cautiously shifting my feet forward.
我忽然感到恐惧，也不再询问，只是屏住呼吸，缓慢地挪动着脚步。

Aunt Alma's back is close, and the moonlight casts a gentle glow on her fine, blonde hair.
艾尔玛姨妈的背影近在咫尺，月光照射在她细软的金发上，变得无比温和。

Atticus: Aunt Alma?
亚齐：……姨妈?

Alma: Hmm? Ah ... look at that, I didn't even notice you were back ...
艾尔玛：嗯？啊……瞧瞧我，我居然一点儿也没注意到你回来了……

Waves roll in again, sweeping over my feet.
浪花席卷上来，没过了我的脚面。

Atticus: I ... called out to you many times, but you didn't respond ...
亚齐：我……喊了您很多次，您没有回应我……

Alma: Is that so?
艾尔玛：是吗?

Alma's voice is soft, her hands warm ... turning hotter. She wraps her arms around my shoulders, drawing my stiff body into her embrace.
艾尔玛的声音柔和，她的手也温热……变得滚烫。她揽住我的肩膀，将僵硬的我搂入怀抱之中。

The sea rises, climbing up to my shins.
海面上升，它攀上了我的小腿。

Alma: I was sorting my thoughts. Sorry, I didn't hear you at all.
艾尔玛：我在梳理思路，抱歉，我一点儿都没听到你的声音。

Alma: Until just now, my mind was a mess, but I'm thinking more clearly now. I've figured it out.
艾尔玛：直到刚刚为止，我的脑子都是一团乱，不过现在好多了，现在我已经想清楚了。

She combs my hair, wiping off the sweat I'd built from running, and straightens my collar.
她为我梳理头发，擦去奔跑导致的汗水，整理领口的衣裳。

Alma: Poor child, you're all sweaty, and there are rat scratches on the hem of your shirt. You must have run into those little monsters ...
艾尔玛：多可怜的孩子，你的身上尽是汗水，衣摆上有着老鼠的抓痕，你一定是遇上了它们……

Alma: Don't be afraid, child.
艾尔玛：不要害怕，孩子。

Alma: "Pray to the gods for what you are about to do, and pray that all goes well."
艾尔玛：“为你将做的事向神祈祷，祈求一切顺利。”

I feel it, the dampness reaching up to my chin.
我感觉到了，湿润感已经触及了我的下颌。

—Who are you?
——你是谁?

A question I find lodged in my throat is choking me so much I can barely breathe.
一个问题哽在喉咙里，它噎得我几乎无法呼吸。

Atticus: Aunt Alma, has something happened here ... ?
亚齐：艾尔玛姨妈，这里是不是发生了什么……

Believer: Alma—and Atticus, come with me—!
教众：艾尔玛——还有亚齐，你们快跟我来——！

The man's shout suddenly rings out.
男人的呼喊声唐突传来。

He just ran past, through the alleys and streets, past the Hall of Apeiron. His sweat-slicked skin shimmers under the moonlight like a soldier bearing bad news, like in the story books of old.
他刚刚奔跑过，穿过小巷和街道，跑过传道者之厅，汗涔涔的皮肤在月光的照射下如同一层闪烁的鳞粉，正如图书中所描述的报丧骑士。

Believer: We need to hurry, faster ... or it'll be too late ... !
教众：我们得快点，再快点……不然就要来不及了……！

Alma: No ... it's already too late.
艾尔玛：不……已经来不及了。

Alma: The "revelation" has come ... it means she—my sister has returned to the truth.
艾尔玛：“启示”已经降临……这意味着她——我的姐姐已经回归了真理。

Alma: The knock of wisdom arrives before me, entering my mind and allowing me to see everything.
艾尔玛：智慧的叩击已经来到我的面前，它进入了我的脑海，使得我看见一切。

Alma pulls the man's hand from my arm.
艾尔玛拉住男人的手，将其从我的手臂上拿开。

Her voice is calm, her face sorrowful. She turns her head slightly and hugs me tighter.
她的声音平静，面色却悲戚，将头偏向了一侧，更用力地将我按进怀抱之中。

Alma: Just, oh, Atticus, my poor child.
艾尔玛：……只是，亚齐，我可怜的孩子。

Alma: My poor child ...
艾尔玛：我可怜的孩子……

Alma became 6 that day.
艾尔玛在那一天成为了 6。

A complete number, a perfect person, and an outstanding leader.
一个完满的数字、一个完美的人、一位出色的领导者。

But 6 was not Alma. Not any longer.
但 6 并不是艾尔玛。

Atticus: Let go of me!
亚齐：放开我！

I wrench her hand away and run desperately, trying to escape the suffocating tide.
我甩开她的手，拼命地奔跑，想要逃离这完满的涨潮之海。

Until the choking waves overwhelm me, and I find myself back on the beach, unconsciously reciting "The Golden Verses."
直到缺氧感将我吞没，我发现自己重新来到沙滩上，正在不自觉地默念《金言》。

My fear originates from it, yet when I feel uncertain, I still return here, like a child who can't imagine straying too far from home.
我的忧惧因其而起，可当我感到彷徨时，我仍是回到了此处，就像年幼的孩子无法离家太远。

Atticus: ...
亚齐：……

Atticus: "Pray to the gods for what you are about to do" ...
亚齐: “为你将做的事向神祈祷”……

Through a blur, the silhouette of the new 6 emerges.
朦胧间，我看到了那位新任 6 的身影。

Complete, wise, her words clear and impeccable like the ancient maxims.
完满，智慧，她的话语一如古老的箴言，明晰且无可挑剔。

Alma: "Pray to the gods for what you are about to do, and pray that all goes well."
艾尔玛: “为你将做的事向神祈祷，祈求一切顺利。”

Alma: "Once familiar with this practice, you will understand the constitution of both eternal gods and mortal men."
艾尔玛: “当你熟悉了这一切，你便会知晓永恒的诸神与有死的凡人之体系。”

Alma: "You will know the extent of all things, the boundaries of their entirety, and what connects them together."
艾尔玛: “知晓世间万物为何者所包容，又如何联结为一。”

Alma: "You will see, as you should, that the nature of the universe flows in all things alike."
艾尔玛: “你将懂得，正如你应当懂得，宇宙在任何地方都是齐一的。”

Alma: "Thus you will not hope for what is beyond your reach, and you will not be deceived."
艾尔玛: “如此，你便不会盼望不该盼望的，亦不会受到蒙蔽。”

I can't think any further. My initial doubts are blocking my thoughts.
我无法再想下去了，最初的怀疑阻断了我的思绪。

Atticus: ... "Revelation" ...
亚齐: ……“启示”……

Atticus: Is this the "revelation" that falls upon a 6?
亚齐: 这就是……会降临在 6 身上的“启示”?

The sea completely engulfs my head, the suffocation reminding me ... that I have lost someone dear to me forever.
海面彻底吞没了我的头顶，窒息感提醒着我……我永远地失去了一个熟知的人。

And this is "the blessing from above."
——而这就是那天上的祝福。

For a long time afterward, I could not sleep in peace. I would often sneak down to the beach, listening to the waves until exhaustion at last closed my eyes.
后来的很长一段时间，我都没能获得安稳的睡眠。我常偷偷溜到沙滩，听着海浪的声音，直到疲惫合上我的双眼。

In a daze, a voice of wisdom would say—
意识模糊间，有那智慧的声音说——

"Don't fear, child. ' Remember that the grace of the gods is given in the form of disaster, and endure it patiently. Such is fate; do not complain.'"
“不要忧惧，孩子。‘谨记神之恩典降给凡人的灾厄，耐心忍耐。天命如此，切勿抱怨。’”

Atticus: ...
亚齐: ……

I vaguely realize something, and I open my eyes to see the silent boulder high on the mountain overlooking the island.
我恍惚地意识到什么，睁开眼睛，看见沉默的巨石在高山上俯瞰岛礁。

One day it will crush me, just as it has crushed Alma.
它终有一天会碾过我，正如碾过每一个艾尔玛。

So, I cover my ears and bend down.
我于是捂住耳朵，弯下身去。

From then on, I no longer gaze at the boulder on the mountain nor look at the teetering bottle on the table.
从此不再凝视高山上的巨石，也拒绝看向桌面之上摇摇欲坠的水瓶。

... Until much later, when I have a brief conversation with a girl named Sophia.
……直到许久之后，我与一位叫苏菲亚的女孩交谈了片刻。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

小石粒
Pebbles COL-307908

Pebbles
小石粒

Stories of fighting against fate are often not all that heart-stirring.
与命运对抗的故事，不全都那么动人心弦。

In this story, there is no shepherd, no messenger, no Sphinx.
在这个故事里，没有牧羊人，没有送信者，没有斯芬克斯。

No head is severed by a sword, no one is born or dies because of it.
没有剑斩下任何一颗头颅，无人因此而生，无人逝去。

Nor can it be told to others.
也无法对他人讲述。

Atticus: What I face is "the revelation" ...
亚齐：我要面对的，是“启示”……

It is an unseen enemy.
那是一个看不见的敌人。

It is described as supreme wisdom, the voice from above. It perpetuates in 6s, urging them to fulfill the mission as leaders.
它被描述为无上的智慧，天上的声音。它会在数字 6 中亘古流传，督促他们去完成领袖的使命。

It's not a tangible bottle. I can't lay a soft cloth to catch the pieces of a soul.
它不是有形的水瓶，我也无法对灵魂铺以软垫。

But her first words inspire me—not everything needs a complete reason.
但她的第一句话启发了我——并非事事都需要完备的理由。

—One must do something. Whatever it is, it's better than just waiting.
——人总得做点什么，不论什么，也比只是等待要好。

... So, is it feasible to fight knowledge with knowledge?
……那么，用知识对抗知识，是可行的么？

Remove the picture book, and the other books in front of me are still more than enough to fill this modest space.
将绘本除去，在我面前的书本也足以将这个不大的空间铺满。

If "the revelation" is the wisdom destined to completely fill a person, perhaps I can do a little preparation work.
倘若“启示”是一种注定将人充盈至完满的智慧，那么也许我能提前做些预习。

It's like filling the bottle with stones beforehand so that it won't be easily knocked over.
就像在水瓶里预先放满石子，好让它不至于被轻易碰落。

Atticus: Hmm, Euclid's "Elements" ...
亚齐：唔，《几何原本》……

In school, it's considered the most basic text, but I dare not say I truly understand it. It is in the simplest of readings that the deepest wisdom is found.
在学派内，那已然是最基础的读物，但我不敢说我真正懂得了它。正是最简明的读物，蕴含了最深刻的智慧。

This is a suitable beginning.
这是一个合适的开始。

Everyone has their own soul number. I am not the one chasing Truth across the beach.
每个人都有自己的灵魂数字，我并非在沙滩上追逐真理之人。

210 and 37 are extremely intelligent children. But most importantly, they have a boundless desire for truth. They build ships, make oars, and sail with gusto into the sea, tirelessly navigating the currents, undaunted by the waves crashing against the hull.
210 和 37 都是极聪慧的孩子。但最重要的是，他们对真理有着无限的渴望。他们造船，做桨，兴致勃勃地向海面航行，在洋流中不知疲倦，不畏惧浪花击打船舷。

While I am the silent reef on the shore, waiting for the day that fate will knock me down, filling the trenches of this seabed.
而我是岸边沉默的礁岩，等待着命运的巨石终有一日将我击落，为这片海床填平沟壑。

Can I withstand that transcendent force? Can I overcome its overwhelming will? It seems almost impossible.
我能抗击那超然的力量吗？我能战胜那超越的意志吗？这几乎是不可能的。

Atticus: ... But regardless, I will make my preparations.
亚齐：……但无论如何，我总得做些准备。

I sit at the table talking to myself.
我坐在桌前，开始和自己交谈。

三一律
Classical Unities COL-307909

Classical Unities
三一律

I see what lies behind the words.
我看到了文字背后的东西。

Knowledge flows from the minds of those who came before to the tips of their pens, then is inked across pages, bound into books, and preserved for the future.
知识从前人的脑中流淌至笔尖，而后铺满纸页，装订成册，得以传承。

This is much like the fate of 6. only that I inherit wisdom from others in a different way.
这与 6 的命运相同，我以不同的方式从他人身上继承智慧。

When you gaze at it, it no longer has a complete form. "Wisdom" is a name forcibly given — it is actually a collection of the complex thoughts of the human species.
当你凝视它，它便不再拥有完整的形态。“智慧”是被硬赋予的名——它本是人类这个种群庞杂思绪的集合。

I drink merrily with mountain thieves, I voyage with heroes, I invite the wise to my side and debate with them.
我与山中盗贼痛饮美酒，我与英雄乘过了同一叶扁舟，我将智者们邀请至身边，与他们辩论。

I read from books as if I were peering into the thoughts of someone else's mind.
我从书上阅读，如同窥视他人颅骨内的思想。

Gradually holding these thoughts in my palm, I realize that, however complex their curves may be, they only have two ends.
逐渐将这些思绪握在掌心，我却发现无论其间的曲线多么复杂，它们都只有两端。

At one end is "life," and at the other is "death."
一端是“生”，另一端是“死”。

Because this is the fate of man. We are like hemp on a spindle, a finite collection despite all our variations.
因为这就是人的命运。我们正如纺锤上的麻绳，虽有万般变化，但终究是有限的集合。

The world is destined for strife, misfortune, and calamity. The good are not always rewarded for their virtues, nor are the wicked always punished for their sins.
而世上注定有纷争，注定有不幸和灾厄。好人并不一定因为他们的德行受到嘉奖，恶人也并不一定因为他们的罪行受到惩罚。

In the end, everything just happens, as purposeless as the pebbles washed up on a beach.
最终，一切只是发生，如沙滩上被冲刷的卵石。

Atticus: ...
亚齐：……

Atticus: Is this all there is?
亚齐：只能，如此了吗?

That night was darker than usual; even the shimmering sea was engulfed by the inky blackness. I felt the sand under my feet slipping away, and I, in my totality, started to float away with it.
那时的夜更黑，连海面上的粼光也被黑夜吞没，我感觉脚下的沙地正在流逝，而我和我的一切开始浮空。

All color faded, and I was suspended in an empty, black space.
一切色彩都褪去了，我在空旷的黑色空间中悬浮着。

That day, Alma wanted to see me. I closed the "Nothingness of Being" and left my room for the first time after a long retreat.
那天，艾尔玛想要见我。我合上《生存空虚说》，在长久的闭关之后第一次离开了房间。

I return to the roofed home and climb up the slope, away from the sea's embrace.
我回到有顶的家，攀上山坡，远离海的边缘。

Alma grabs my hand. She's heard of my recent struggles and worries that I am falling into the void of knowledge.
艾尔玛拽住我的手，她听说了我的近况，担心我落入知识的虚无之中。

I guess every word before she speaks—6's wisdom, the ancient maxims, the advice of "The Golden Verses"—I've heard them all endlessly.
我猜中了她要对我说的每一句话——6 的智慧，古老的箴言，《金言》的劝导，我早已听过无数遍。

I don't blame her, this is the 6's duty, her destiny.
我并不责怪她，这是 6 的职责，也是她的命运。

I brush her hand away and return to my own battlefield.
我拂开了她的手，回到我自己的战场中去。

Even if knowledge leads to void, I need to use it to confront that unknown "revelation."
即使知识会导向虚无，我也需要用它来面对那未知的“启示”。

210: —!
210: ——!

Someone stops me. It's 210. I hear him speak with intense emotion about "the revelation".
有谁拦住了我，是 210。我听到他情绪激烈，口中提到的正是“启示”。

Atticus: The revelation is a curse, my friend.
亚齐: 那是诅咒，我的朋友。

I shouldn't have answered, for this is not his fate. He always tries to meddle in matters far beyond his abilities, which only brings disaster upon himself and others.
我本不应回答，因为这并非他的命运。他总是试图染指远超自己能力之事，这会为他带来灾厄。

Cautious Daedalus and proud Icarus both fitted themselves with wings and attempted to fly over the sea.
谨慎的代达罗斯和骄傲的伊卡洛斯同时给自己装上翅膀，试图飞跃大海。

The former landed safely at a low altitude, while the latter flew too close to the sun, only to fall from the sky under its wax-melting heat.
前者在不高的空中安全落地，后者则迎着太阳高飞，最终在烈阳的洗礼中坠落。

It's not hard to see the one he more closely resembles.
不难看出他属于哪一种。

Thirty-seven: ... ?
37: ……?

Someone enters my retreat. It's 37. She's always curious, always puzzling and questioning.
有人进入了我的闭关处，是 37。她总是好奇，也总是感到不解和疑惑。

Fortunately, she also always firmly believes she is right.
好在，她总是坚信自己是对的。

Atticus: ... Sorry, 37. I can't help you with this right now.
亚齐: ……很抱歉，37。我暂时没有办法帮助你解决这个问题。

In truth I can answer her; my own questions earlier were as much or more profound than hers.
我可以回答她，因为我比她疑惑得更早，更深。

And perhaps I could offer many wise answers, but they might do her more harm than good.
我可以提供许多智慧的解答，可这些对她或许是百害而无一利的。

The sea nymph Thetis dipped her son Achilles in the River Styx, granting him immortality.
海洋女神忒提斯将她的儿子阿基里斯放入冥河中浸泡，让其拥有不死之身。

To keep her baby from being swept away by the strong current, the mother held onto him by the heel. Her love made Achilles' heel his one fatal weakness.
因为冥河水流湍急，这位母亲捏住婴儿的脚后跟不敢松手。她的爱让脚踵成为阿基里斯唯一的致命弱点。

It's not hard to see where 37's own weaknesses lie. At the very least, I shouldn't reveal them prematurely.
不难看出 37 的弱点在何处。至少，我不应提前揭开它。

I close the door again and sit in silence.
我重新关上门，静坐于缄默之中。

And who am I? To which fable do I belong?
那我又是谁呢？我又属于哪一个寓言？

Yes, I know that too.
是的，我也知晓。

—Oedipus went through his struggles and met his prophesied doom. Thus, the perfect tragedy came into being.
——俄狄浦斯经历了他的挣扎，迎来了预言中的厄运。于是，十全十美的悲剧诞生了。

Everything is crystal clear.
一切都清清楚楚，明明白白。

Atticus: ... Now I know it all.
亚齐：……现在我都知道了。

Atticus: But what do I do next?
亚齐：可是，这之后又要怎么办呢？

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

海面以下
Underneath the Sea Level COL-307910

Underneath the Sea Level
海面以下

Since the night my mother passed away, I haven't set foot in the cemetery where she is buried.
自从母亲去世的那个晚上，我便再没有踏入她的墓地。

It's truly unsettling when fate presents itself in such a tangible form.
命运以如此实际的面貌呈现在面前时，实在让人感到不适。

But then, on a whim, I decided to go there.
但那时候，突发奇想地，我决定来到这里。

It was like receiving a revelation.
就像蒙受一种启示。

Atticus: ... Alma?
亚齐：……艾尔玛？

She ought to be busy preparing for the voyage, but here she is, standing silently on the grass, like a living tombstone.
她理应在为出航的事操劳，此刻却静默地独立于草地上，就像一座活着的墓碑。

When she sees me, she isn't surprised, as if she had already known what fate had planned.
她瞧见我，却并不惊讶，仿佛早已知晓命运的安排。

Alma: Atticus, my child, your timing is perfect.
艾尔玛：亚齐，我的孩子，你来得正好。

Alma: I know you've always harbored doubts, and our shared bloodline has only added to this divide.
艾尔玛：我知道你一直心存疑虑，我们相连的血脉反而增加了这种隔阂。

Alma: You've tried to counter the 'revelation' with knowledge, but it only leads you further into confusion. You get lost in a maze of thoughts and fears, unable to find the red thread of escape.
艾尔玛：你试图以知识对抗“启示”，可那也令你愈发疑惑。你会迷失在思绪的迷宫中，找不到脱逃的红色线头。

Atticus: ... I've heard this before, Alma.
亚齐：……这些话我已经听过了，艾尔玛。

She smiles, shaking her head, and pulls out a hardcover book.
她微笑着摇了摇头，拿出一本硬质的书籍。

Alma: I think you're going to need this.
艾尔玛：我想你会需要这个。

Alma: Good afternoon, child.
艾尔玛：午安，孩子。

I hear her footsteps fade away beyond the trees, like a dewdrop sliding off a leaf.
我听见她的脚步声消失在树影之后，如一滴露水从树叶上滑落。

Lowering my head, I see the name of the book.
低下头，我看见了这本书籍的名称。

Atticus: The Voice From Above.
亚齐：《来自于天上的声音》……

It's a children's picture book, familiar to every child on the island. It has been endlessly discussed and even argued over. The story is vivid and clear in my mind without even seeing the pages.
那是一册儿童绘本，岛上的每个孩子都熟悉它，讨论过它，甚至因它发生过争执。
无需阅读书页，它也在我的脑中清晰可见。

Atticus: "A voice from the above spoke to a man, 'An important thing will happen to you.'"
亚齐：天上的声音如是说，有件大事将要发生在你身上……

Atticus: Thus, he spends his life waiting for a miracle.
亚齐：于是，他终其一生地等待一个奇迹。

Atticus: Until death arrives, and nothing has happened.
亚齐：直至死亡到来，一切仍未发生。

Atticus: "When the man lay sick in bed, he cried up to the voice from above, asking, 'When will all that you have promised finally arrive?'"
亚齐：那人缠绵病榻时，又对天上的声音询问，那件大事在何时发生?

Atticus: "The voice from above said, 'I gave you countless opportunities to work miracles, but you missed them all.'"
亚齐：天上的声音说：“我曾予以你无数创造奇迹的机会，可你都错失了。”

Atticus: "Because you thought you knew your fate, you took no action. In the end, you achieved nothing."
亚齐：“因为你自以为知晓了命运，于是不再采取任何行动。最终，一事无成。”

I used to despise this story because it dressed the will of the heavens as a kind of desirable benefit and said nothing about the cruelty of fate.
我曾憎恶过这个故事，因为它将天上的意志包装为某种趋之若鹜的好处，对命运的冷酷只字未提。

But stripping away all misunderstandings, its message is simple: Do not wait; you must take destiny into your own hands.
但撇去所有误解，它的寓意是如此简单：不要一味等待，需主动去承担自己的天命。

—This is something I've long known and acted by.
——这是我早就知道的事，也是我已经做出的事。

Atticus: ... What else is there in this book that I had missed? That I needed?
亚齐：……这本书里，究竟还有什么我需要的内容呢?

Before I realized it, I found I had walked to the beach. And it was already dark.
当我意识到，自己已踱步来到沙滩时，天已经黑了下来。

海面以下
Underneath the Sea Level COL-307911

The days that follow are calm.
之后的日子十分平静。

The believers, seeking truth and knowledge, sail out to explore a world of constantly changing phenomena.
信仰者们带着对真理和知识的渴求，出海探索那个变动不安的现象世界。

But the ship's return is far later than expected.
船归航的时间却远远地超出了预料。

Believer I: No ... impossible, they are already well past the maximum deviation possible. They must return today ...
教众 I： 不……不可能，这已经是最大的偏差可能性了，无论如何，今天他们一定回来才对……

Believer I: As long as they are alive and on the ship, there's no way they cannot be headed back ...
教众 I： 只要他们还活着，还能坐上船，就不可能回不到岛上来……

They wait day and night by the coast, eagerly anticipating the return of their leader and the ship.
人们日以继夜地等待在海岸旁，渴盼着领袖与船舶的归来。

Soon, they grow increasingly panicked.
很快，他们开始越来越恐慌。

Believer II: Hey - look, that's the ship!
教众 II： 嘿——看那，那是船!

Until one person shouts excitedly, jumping high with the joyful news.
直到有一个人振臂而呼，高高地跳起，带来喜悦的消息。

Believer I: I knew it, I knew they were alright!
教众 I： 太好了，我就知道他们没事!

Believer II: I'm so glad–
教众 II： 太好了——

The ship returns from its voyage along its planned route, with no deviation in angle or speed.
远航的船沿照既定的航线归来，角度与时速都毫无偏差。

People run to the coast, waiting to welcome new insights from the outside world, believing these unprecedented ideas will illuminate the path of truth.
人们跑向海岸，等待着迎接来自于外界的新知卓见，他们相信，那些前所未有的想法一定能在真理的道路上引领光辉。

Sophia: Dad—!
苏菲亚： 爸爸——!

Among them is Atticus's dear friend.
亚齐真诚的朋友也在其中。

Sophia: —
苏菲亚：——

The "emanation" descends upon them.
“流溢”是在他们面前降临的。

Everyone is calling out; everyone is in an uproar. They scream, cry, and fall to the sandy ground.
无人不在呼唤，无人不在喧闹。他们嘶吼、哭喊、跌倒在沙地上。

The ominous noise even reaches the roofed room.
这不祥的喧闹也传到了那个有顶的房间内。

Atticus: ...
亚齐：……

Ignoring his trembling fingers, Atticus takes the book and opens it on the table.
亚齐罔顾颤抖的手指，拿下了书本，将它在桌上摊开。

Regardless of the worst outcome, this is what he had planned to do.
无论最坏的结果是否发生，这都是他本来预计要做的事。

Atticus: "A voice from the above spoke to a man."
亚齐：……天上的声音如是说。

Atticus: An important thing will happen to you.
亚齐：有件大事将要发生在你身上。

Atticus: What will it be? The man asked.
亚齐：那人便开口问了，那是什么样的事?

Atticus: You will gain wealth, you will gain fame. You will walk in the garden of wisdom and happiness. The voice answered ...
亚齐：天上的声音回答，你将变得富足美满，拥有智慧与声名……

The reading voice stops. His fingers lingering on the page.
朗读的声音停止了。他的手指停在书页之上。

At the same time, a geometric shape washes ashore.
与此同时，一个几何体被冲刷到了岸上。

It's a beautiful tetrahedron, brilliant with a golden hue like Alma's shining blonde hair when she was in good health.
那是一个漂亮的三棱锥，金色的荧光如同艾尔玛仍在康健时期的美丽金发。

—The "revelation" has knocked on his door.
——“启示”叩响了门扉。

Countless ancient knowledge is conveyed through the imprint of the Soul Number 6.
无数古老的知识，顺着灵魂数字 6 的烙印传递而来。

Moral, historical, empirical, abstract, mathematical, humanistic.
道德的，历史的，经验的，抽象的，数理的，人文的。

This is the crystallization of wisdom passed down from generation to generation by the island's leaders, a glimpse of the mysteries transmitted through the bloodline by those who perceive the truth.
这是学派领袖代代相传的智慧结晶，窥见真理之人通过血脉传下的奥妙一隅。

Revelation, knowledge, wisdom —
启示，知识，智慧——

They surge so tumultuously and vastly that entire lifetimes of achievements and thoughts from mortals are like bottles of water compared to the mighty ocean.
它们如此汹涌而浩瀚，凡人的一生所得与所思所想和它们相比，就如大海之于水瓶。

The boulder of fate has rolled down from its peak, and a new 6 is born.
命运的巨石已然落下，新的 6 诞生了。

Six: ...
6：……

The reef remains unchanged. It has been hardened by the erosive force during the long night.
礁岩仍未改变分毫，它早已在长夜的磨砺中变得足够坚硬。

The paused hand gently falls and turns the page.
停驻的手轻轻落下，将那页揭过。

Six: "Revelation" ...
6：“启示”……

Six: It is just as simple as it is.
6：……原来，不过如此而已。

THE END
THE END

穷举法
Method of Exhaustion COL-307912

Atticus: Are you here to collect your sand again today?
亚齐：你今天仍旧是来装细沙的?

Sophia: Yes. The fine sand here is ideal for polishing lenses. My father's eyeglasses are just about ready.
苏菲亚：是的，细沙子可以很好地打磨镜片，那副眼镜就快要做好了。

Sophia is a hard-working girl. She is always ready to change, to become a better version of herself.
苏菲亚是一个努力的姑娘。她无时无刻不准备着改变自己，成为更好的自己。

She knows nothing of her future fate and, therefore, has no fear. Her core is so firm, her steps so sure. It's enviable.
她对自己未来的命运一无所知，因此也没有任何惧怕。内核如此坚固，行得踏实，令人艳羡。

Perhaps that's one of the reasons I asked her that question.
这也许是我对她提出那个问题的原因之一。

Atticus: ... Why do you choose to struggle so much against the path of fate?
亚齐：……你为什么会选择在命运的道路上如此挣扎?

I didn't really expect an answer from her; it was just spontaneous curiosity.
我并没有奢求过她的回答，这只是出于偶发的好奇。

We are entirely different people. Even if she gave her reasons, they wouldn't help me, not really.
我们是完全不同的人。即使她给出了自己的理由，那也不会对我有所启示。

Because I have exhausted every possibility and sought every line of reasoning.
因为我已经穷尽了每一种可能，求索了每一条道理。

My question is unsolvable.
这个问题是无解的。

Sophia remains silent, wanting to say something but hesitating. She twists the ends of her hair, avoiding my eyes.
苏菲亚沉默着，她想说些什么，但又有所犹豫，手指拧着卷发的末端，眼神闪避。

Sophia: ... I have to do something, anything.
苏菲亚：……我总得做点什么，不论什么都好。

That's a peculiar answer.
这是一个相当奇怪的回答。

Without any reason, any logic, just "doing something."
它没有任何理由，任何道理，仅仅是要“做点什么”。

So, I am left puzzled again.
于是我再度疑惑了。

Sophia: ... But preparing for what must come is better than doing nothing at all.
苏菲亚：……面对即将要发生的事，做些准备，总比不做准备要来得更好。

Sophia: Right, the glass bottle—like the one on the table ...
苏菲亚：对了，水瓶——就像是桌子上的水瓶……

She flusteredly tries to give an example, inventing a glass bottle that is bound to break, then surrounding it with a cloth.
她手足无措地试图举例，她虚构出一只必然破碎的水瓶，而后在其周围铺满软垫。

This way, even if the bottle still breaks, we can pick up the pieces more easily.
这样，即使水瓶仍旧破碎，我们也能更方便地捡拾它的碎片。

It's a practical explanation—pragmatic and devoid of abstraction. This is her answer to fate, the total opposite of mine.
这是个实用的好解释——务实勤勉，没有任何抽象。这是属于她命运的解答，与我截然相反。

Atticus: Thank you for the long talk, Sophia.
亚齐：……谢谢你对我说这么多，苏菲亚。

A new path is carved out between the waters.
一条新的道路从海水之间被开辟出来。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…